The days without you

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/60191950.

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General Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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The days without you

by Garlogan10

Summary

What if Catra had died during the invasion? Horde Prime was defeated, Etheria was safe, the universe is safe… but what will happen to Adora and her friends now?

Notes

This story was already ready and posted on other platforms, and I wasn't sure if I was going to post it here. But I miss She-ra, so I'm working on another story that will have links to this one; and so as not to confuse you guys, I've decided to post it.

Let me know of any mistakes. I hope you like it, and I hope I can do the next story. <3

The return to Etheria

[…]

It's been months since the fall of Prime. Etheria has never been as peaceful as it is now, without evil clones, Prime, or the horde. Peace reigned, at least for the other inhabitants. For Adora, Glimmer and Bow, things were still adjusting.

Adora left Etheria and is now on a solitary journey across the universe. Glimmer and Bow got married and became great leaders. The rebellion was extinguished, but the princesses remained united, celebrating peace at dinners and balls. If someone had said two years ago that things would end like this, Adora would probably have called them crazy. But now, on board her ship, with only her thoughts and unrecoverable memories, she believes it.

Yes… all her achievements, all the battles fought, the lives protected. She was proud to be She-ra… but after that day, being She-ra no longer made sense to Adora. Catra was her light, and as she returned to the bright moon without her cat, as she tried to hold back her tears until the last moment, she realized that she had failed. She was She-ra, the guardian of Etheria, but now she wanted nothing more. She would just carry on, as the cat had asked in her final sighs. "Keep being amazing…" She would persist, because she knows that if the cat were here, that's what she would want. Whenever she helped someone, the figure of the cat would appear in her mind, with its kind smile and mischievous glint in its eyes. Even if it was just a creation of his mind, being able to see her was still a blessing.

And her voice… It was impossible to forget her voice, a sweet, gentle timbre that would echo forever in his memory. The mere idea of kissing and hugging her was tempting, even though the feline character in his dreams was an illusion. In her dreams, she found herself under a tree, stroking the cat while it purred softly,

bringing a silly smile to Adora's face. She liked it there, she loves it. It's her corner of peace.

Despite feeling incomplete, Adora avoided talking to her friends for a long time. She knew she had to leave certain things behind, because she wouldn't be able to move on in Etheria without her. However, after a long period of absence, Glimmer finally received a sign: the savior of the universe was returning home.

The queen spent hours organizing a warm welcome for her friend, it would be amazing to have her back after so long, and she was looking forward to catching up on gossip.

— It's going to be the best week ever! — Glimmer exclaimed enthusiastically. Meeting Adora again after so many months was her greatest wish. To hug her, to find out how she's doing, what she's been up to, were questions she couldn't wait to ask.

— Calm down, love, let's let her rest first and then we'll get to the questions. And for that, I've prepared a lively afternoon just for the three of us! Best friends forever together again! — Bow says excitedly. — It's been so long…

— That's right… too long. — Glimmer hugs Bow, letting a stubborn tear escape. It seemed like years had passed, but in reality it had only been months. But without Adora and Catra, it was like a knife in their hearts. Glimmer had gotten close to the cat, and seeing her go made his heart squeeze. Bow didn't leave his room for two days after Adora left, he missed her, but they had to move on.

— Excuse me, Your Majesties? Everything is ready for She-ra's arrival! As requested. — The guard left immediately afterward.

— Thank you! Okay, let's call the other princesses, go over the final details and then we'll be ready! — Exclaimed an excited Glimmer, jumping for joy. — I'm off to Frosta's castle, I'll see you later! — Before she could even say goodbye, Glimmer had already

disappeared, leaving behind a few sparkles and a smile on her husband's face.

…

At last, the long-awaited day had arrived, and everyone was gathered in front of the great bright moon castle, full of excitement. When the ship could finally be seen, cheers and shouts of joy echoed through the air. Glimmer and Bow, along with the other princesses, approached as the ship landed. With anxiety pulsing and the joy of having Adora back, it was indescribable. When the ship's door opened, surprise overtook everyone.

For months, they wondered how much Adora had changed, but nothing could have prepared them for what they saw. She was a little taller, with short hair and a scar on her eyebrow. But what really surprised them was the little feline by her side.

— Adora! — Glimmer shouted, running to hug Adora, who welcomed her with open arms. Soon after, Bow and the others came over to hug the older girl.

— Hi, everyone! Sorry I'm late. — Adora said in a slightly different voice, indicating that her height wasn't the only change. Adora hugs everyone and greets the citizens present, before finally leaving for the castle. When they returned, Adora took the little boy in her arms, smiling to convey her confidence, and the boy smiled back, holding onto her neck.

— And who would that be? — Mermista asks, staring at the little one.

— This… is Finn. Say hi, Finn! — The little one looks at everyone, hides his face and Adora to laugh slightly. — He's a bit shy, hehe…

— Well, shall we go in? We've got a big day ahead of us! — Everyone came in excited to start an incredible day. Hours of conversations, drinks, and food were enjoyed, as well as various attractions and shows scheduled. Everything was going according

to plan for the queen. Adora had fun telling everyone about her adventures. Everything was perfect, but Glimmer and Bow were still wondering where that little one next to Adora had come from.

What puzzled them most was the fact that the little one was so similar to a certain cat, except for his blond hair and blue eyes; otherwise, he looked like Catra. This caused a slight apprehension in the queen's heart, and Bow gave her a downcast look, which was noticed by everyone, although they tried to keep a smile on their faces.

— What do you think? Should we ask…? — Bow asked Glimmer, as they watched Adora together. The little one wouldn't let go of her hand and, whenever he hid behind it, Adora took him in her arms, comforting him. It was obvious that everyone found the situation strange, as they wanted to know where Adora had found him and what had happened. However, as it was a festive day, no one wanted to spoil the light mood.

— I don't know… I think it's better to do it with just the three of us. Let's wait until tomorrow. — concluded Glimmer, finishing his drink and heading towards Adora and the others.

The day turned into night and the party wasn't over yet, everyone was happy, dancing and having fun like never before. It was a perfect day, but while some princesses were forcing smiles, Adora was doing the same, even walking away with the little one when he looked like he wanted to cry. She was acting like a real mother in everyone's eyes, and this was surprising, increasing everyone's curiosity even more.

— Where's Adora? — asked Perfuma, arriving with Scorpia.

— Over there! — she looked where Bow pointed, spotting Adora with the little one in her arms, putting him to sleep.

— Wow… she looks…

— Different? — commented Glimmer.

— A mother? — suggested Frosta.

— Or super, super weird? — said Mermista.

— I'd say super responsible! Where did that child come from? — asked Scorpia, looking at her friends, who just shrugged and went back to watching Adora.

It was really strange what was happening, but no one had the courage to question it. Even though she kept her usual cheerful expression, everyone knew that bringing up certain subjects could upset her, so they opted to focus only on light and fun topics.

The evening ended well, with the activities and shows coming to an end and the princesses preparing to return to their kingdoms. Except for Frosta, Scorpia and Perfuma, who decided to stay and leave only in the morning. Glimmer and Bow accompanied Adora to her room, in silence, watching her care for the little one in her arms.

— Here we are! Your old room. We haven't touched anything. — said Glimmer as he opened the door. Adora looked at everything carefully, it was amazing how tidy everything was, even though everything was still exactly the same. After putting the little one to bed, she stretched before starting to walk around the room. Bow was at the door and Glimmer by the window waiting for the blonde to say something.

— Everything looks great… I can't believe it's been so long. — Adora comments, running a hand through her hair and admiring the room. Even her old painting is here, it was an incredible feeling of nostalgia. — I thought they would have changed something by now, heheh…

— Yeah… we haven't managed to change it. It's your room, it always will be! — Bow says with a smile. Adora returned the smile, coming closer to him and giving him a tight hug. They start to say a few things, laughing quietly, until they start to play wrestle, making Glimmer laugh at the scene. The little boy starts

to call out to Adora, which makes her stop immediately and run to meet him.

— Hey~ It's okay… I'm here… — The way she speaks, the way she runs to hold him, the way she's comforting him, leaves Glimmer and Bow surprised. Adora seemed to be the same as before, but she had certainly changed a lot. But Glimmer knew that in all that care, there was a certain sense of pain in Adora. She saw it, she felt it… it's still hurting.

A not-so-perfect day

Chapter Notes

> Hello again! If there was any error, please let me know and I will do my best to resolve it. Thanks! <3

[...]

It was hard to imagine what the eldest had gone through, all those months alone, without giving any sign of life. They remembered very well the day she left, making it clear that if she came back, it wouldn't be to stay. The memory of the conversation was painful, because it wouldn't be the same without Adora, and for Adora, it wouldn't be the same without Catra. They understood her decision, but hoped to work it out together. They even tried to change her mind, but as they talked, they realized that she needed some time. To allow herself to feel that, to stop being She-ra and just be... herself. When she left, they didn't really know if they would see her again, and they were afraid when she didn't send any news, until, two weeks later, she sent a sign that she was fine. This left them relieved, and with their feet on the ground, about how things were going to be from now on.

Glimmer knows that best friends need to talk, but given Adora's condition, she doesn't know how to approach her. There's a certain fear of upsetting her. After the way she's been since Catra left and how she defeated Prime, Glimmer didn't see She-ra or Adora... she only saw someone corrupted by *hatred* . Watching her friend like that made her realize that it would take a long time for Adora to get over it. And knowing that she can't help makes her very sad.

— So... I've planned an incredible day tomorrow, just for the three of us! — Bow says with a broad smile. — We'll have a picnic, a boat trip, a nice evening stargazing and food! Lots and lots of delicious food!

— And I'm the one who prepared it all! — Glimmer says proudly.

— Wow! What a miracle you're cooking, heheh… — Adora says, picking on the other. — I'll love anything you do, I just want to… relax with my friends. — She says with a forced smile.

— Adora… if you want to talk, know that we're here. — said Bow, touching her shoulder. She responded with a weak smile and hugged him. Glimmer joined them and they stayed together for a while.

The next day, Bow was the first to get out of bed (they slept in Adora's room). He was so excited that he ended up screaming with joy, which made Adora and Glimmer throw pillows at him. After tidying up, they set off out of the castle on their way to a perfect day. Adora was overjoyed, showing every detail of the place to the little one, who watched intently, sometimes laughing at Bow and Glimmer's antics.

Even though she felt lighter after so long, Adora still saw her cat everywhere, because everything reminded her of her. Catra was there, she could feel it, with a big smile and an affectionate look. She could hear his voice calling her, the sweet sound of his voice… how she missed it.

— Adora? — Bow calls out to her, who is standing staring at the path into the whispering forest. In the distance, she could see Catra running excitedly. — Adora! — Bow shakes her shoulder, bringing her back.

— Oh, sorry… what were you saying? — She asks, walking back.

— We're almost there. You're going to love it! — He says excitedly, but his smile is soon replaced by a worried look. — Hey… you know you can talk to us, right?

— Sure, I know… I'm sorry I haven't given you much news. — she says, looking down. — A lot of things happened, and it was all so fast that I didn't even know how to cope. It's still hard…

— I know it is, but you'll manage. And well… you could stay with us for a while, couldn't you…? — He said, laughing slightly, but Adora didn't like the proposal. — Don't get me wrong, it's just that you can… if you want to! We can help you…

— Bow…

— We're here, it's okay! We'll always be there for you. It's just that, being in the universe, it's a bit difficult to know how you're doing. But no judgment! It was your choice, and I respect that.

— Bow.

— But if you'd stayed, we could have helped even more!

— Bow! — They exclaim, making Bow look ahead. — We're here! — Glimmer says, taking the picnic basket from their hands.

— Ah, yes… — He replies, trying to smile.

— Hey, relax! It's all right. But I'm still firm in my decision. — She says, patting her back before following Glimmer. In her mind, Adora just wanted to rest, she was carrying a lot of things and relaxing was her only wish right now. After all, it's good to be back.

However, she is aware that her friends are looking for answers. They all want to know what's behind the riddle they were all curious to unravel the day before. Honestly, she felt a little uncomfortable with the way everyone was looking at the little boy. She nurtures a strong bond with this child, who is extremely important to her, because whenever the little one cries, her heart breaks a little.

— So~ Let's start with the first item on our list. — says Glimmer, excited.

— I didn't even know we had a list. — replies Adora, as she sits down on the towel with the little one on her lap.

— I made it before we left. Look, the first item is to eat everything in the basket and play lots of fun games! — Glimmer says, jumping for joy, getting laughs from Adora and Bow with his excitement.

— I'm all about food! Hey, little buddy… what do you like? You can take what you like. — says Bow, offering some fruit to the little one, who just looks and hides in Adora's lap. — Am I so bad with children? — Bow asked in a mournful tone, which drew laughter from both of them.

— He doesn't eat much of that stuff. I brought his milk in my bag. Don't worry about it. — Okay, that was killing them both inside. They needed to ask, they wanted to ask, and Adora knew it.

— Adora… where did you find him? — Bow asked, staring at Adora.

— We don't mean to be annoying or anything, but you've been gone for a long time. Do you… by any chance… know? — Glimmer gestured with his hand, simulating a belly, which made Adora laugh. — I'm serious, Adora!

— Sorry! Hahaha! But no… it wasn't like that. I was traveling when I met the star brothers. I went with them to their planet and, while they were showing me around, this little guy tried to steal it from me. — She explained, perplexing them both.

— He tried to steal from you! But how? He's just…

— A child! — Bow watched the little one play with some flowers. — So, what did you do?

— At first, I was really surprised. He escaped, and we followed him, and when we got to where he was hiding, we saw that he was alone. No mother, father, brother, or sister… completely alone. I got close to him, and he tried to attack me, and when I managed to restrain him, he started crying.

— And where exactly did you find him? — Glimmer asks.

— … It was a horrible place. No light, no water. He didn't even have any clothes on, he was wearing a sack as a shirt. When we searched the house, I immediately realized that he had been abandoned. There were no signs of theft or invasion of Prime, they just… left him. — she says, watching him play happily in the field.

— Wow… that's so sad. He's so small. It must have been very hard to be alone in that place, poor thing! — says Glimmer, with tears in his eyes. It was really distressing. How could they just throw him away as if he was worthless…?

— Later, the brothers and I went into town to look for someone who could help. We found a place, but it took days, and he was already very attached to me. When I tried to leave him, he started crying so much that I couldn't leave him… I couldn't.

That day, it was hard to resist tears when I saw him crying like that. He was desperately trying to get off the other woman's lap, screaming for her. His heart refused to go away, so she picked him up, promising to take care of him. And so it was, she looked after him, provided him with some clothes (with the help of his brothers) and fed him. Anyone who saw him before and now wouldn't believe the change.

— Wow, what a story! And now you're his mother. That's incredible! — Bow expresses his enthusiasm, while Adora turns to her friend with a puzzled expression.

— I'm not his mother. I'm just looking after him. When he grows up a bit more and understands things better, I'll take him to a proper family. Staying with me is *risky* and I… — Adora suddenly interrupted, fixing her gaze on the vast flowery field. The two friends were confused, looking where Adora was looking, but they saw nothing – they exchanged puzzled glances. But in Adora's eyes, there was Catra, with his warm smile and sweet voice calling out to her.

— Adora… — Glimmer called out to her friend, without getting an answer. — Adora! — she tries again, finally catching her friend's attention. — Are you all right? You've stopped talking. — She asks, worried.

— … Everything's fine. It's nothing… — she mumbles, finishing her meal. Glimmer knew that the perfect day wasn't being so perfect. She wanted it to be, but she couldn't ignore what was happening; they needed to sort it out, they needed to talk about her. About Catra.

— Adora, we need to talk about her… — said Bow, while Adora just shook her head and closed her eyes. — Adora! — he called, as she stood up and took the little one on her lap, leaving her friends behind. They also got up to follow her, but the more they called her, the faster she sped off.

— Adora! You need to stop! Look at yourself! — Glimmer exclaimed after her friend.

— What do you want me to say? — shouted Adora, turning to the two of them and scaring them. — What do you expect from me? Do you want me to admit that I failed? That I should have tried harder? That it was all my fault?

— None of that is true, Adora! We just want to talk to you, but you're not helping us to help you! — said Bow, taking the lead. The little one curled up on his lap and Adora hugged him protectively.

— So, what do you want me to say…? — she asked, holding back tears.

— Tell me how you feel. You don't have to keep it all inside, Adora. This guilt, this pain… none of it is good for you. Talk, shout, cry, do whatever you have to! Just don't push us away. The three of us share the same pain… you're not alone.

Adora holds the little one tighter, making him cry. She looks at him, frightened, and Bow quickly takes him out of her arms,

calming him down.

— I-I didn't… I didn't mean to make him cry! I'm sorry… — Adora says desperately. Her hands are cold, she's panting, her head is spinning, and she feels a knot forming in her throat. Adora runs off, leaving the three of them behind.

A smile changes everything

[…]

More than three hours have passed looking for Adora. They searched the picnic site again and even went back to the light moon to check the ship, but Adora had disappeared.

— Do you think we took it too hard? Maybe if we… hadn't said anything, it would have been a perfect day. — Says Glimmer with the little sleeper in his arms. Bow, normally cheerful, was serious.

— No, we did the right thing. Adora has to face it. It was hard at first, but we got through it together! She needs to understand! She's not alone and even if she needed a break, she didn't have to go so far away. I thought we were more than friends…

Moving on, they entered the forest of whispers and found Adora staring at one of the former's installations. She remained motionless, her hands in her pockets, staring at the place without blinking, until she realized their presence.

— When I left, I believed I could get over it. But every day, every night, was a lie. I couldn't get over it, I failed to keep the one promise I made to her.

— Adora… — Glimmer tries to move closer, but Adora glares at her over her shoulder.

— How could I move on? If I went in there, I'd revisit all my oldest memories, but I don't need to go in to see her… because she's always with me! — For months, she thought she could get over it, but she couldn't. She would never forgive herself for not telling her how much she loved her. That was his biggest mistake.

— The stories you told… were they true? — Glimmer asks apprehensively. Throughout the party, Adora avoided mentioning She-ra.

— Some of them were… — Adora replies with an icy stare, turning to face them both. — All the adventures, everything I told you, were partly true. But when I left Etheria, I couldn't turn into She-ra anymore.

— What…? So…

— Yes! I haven't been able to transform for months. I told you those things, and they were true, except for the parts about She-ra. I didn't want anyone worrying about me. — She says, looking away. — I don't see any reason to go on being She-Ra without her. Everywhere I look… there she is! Always there, watching me, smiling as if nothing had happened, as if to say that everything will be fine, but it's not! — She exclaimed angrily, shaking her head. — How can I go on… if the days without you… have no meaning? — Adora fell to her knees on the floor, crying.

Glimmer holds Finn in his arms, but the little one soon lets go and walks over to Adora. Finn touches her head, making her raise her face, and when she meets his gaze, she doesn't just see Finn, she sees Catra. Always.

— We didn't know Catra like you. But if she were here, she'd push you off a cliff, hahah! — Bow laughs as he remembers when they arrested the cat. — And… if she were here, I'm sure she'd say that crying is a stupid thing to do, but she'd still cry in hiding.

— If she were here, she'd certainly be the first to steal food from the kitchen in the middle of the night, and she'd probably blame us, hehe! — says Glimmer as he sits down next to her. — She told me that you also had slumber parties. You teased Kyle and talked about various things.

— Yes… I remember… — The blonde smiles faintly.

— Adora, you need to stop living in the past! Your life goes on, and even though you desperately want to change everything, you can't. The universe is fine, but you'll always need She-ra. And most importantly, we will always need you, Adora. Because you're

too important to give up on yourself. — Bow says, touching her shoulder to comfort her. — The universe will always have She-ra, but it will never have an Adora. And we're lucky to have you. And I know Catra wouldn't like to see you like this… and if she's here, do you really think she deserves to go away and see you cry? — These words made Adora reflect on every time the cat appeared, in dreams, in places, or even at that moment. She had never smiled back.

Adora looks at the little one, who is also looking at the trees. Adora touches his arm, making him look at her. He doesn't understand what's going on, but he can see that Adora isn't well, so, in an attempt to ease the situation, he hugs her tightly and Adora responds.

— Why don't we go back to the castle? It's getting late. — Glimmer suggests, followed by Bow and Adora. On the way back home, even though she tries not to look, Adora hears Catra calling her and turns back, seeing the cat smiling.

The little one on her lap wiggles, pointing in Catra's direction. — Do you see her too? — Adora asks, looking at Catra. Even when she's crying, the cat keeps smiling. " *If she smiled back… would you disappear?* " thinks Adora.

— Mama! — shouts the little one, bringing Adora out of her thoughts. — M-Mama! — he shouts again, pointing at Catra. Adora looks at the cat, letting a tear fall, but Catra isn't smiling, she's looking at the little one on her lap, who is smiling at her animatedly. Catra looks at Adora once more, a sincere smile forming on her face. She knows what needs to be done. " *It's time to say goodbye.* "

Even as she fights back tears, Adora smiles at Catra, who gradually begins to disappear. As a farewell, she blows them both a kiss and finally disappears. The little one regains his composure and wipes away her tears, gently touching her face.

— Shall we go home? — says Adora, making the little one smile. She hears Bow calling out to her, wipes away her tears, puts the little one down, who turns to Glimmer as they walk. Concerned, they both look at her, but Adora smiles at them. Her eyes are red from crying, but she still smiles at her friends, who hug her tightly.

— She's at peace now, Adora. I'm sure that, wherever she is, she's proud of you. Just as we are. You're not just She-ra, you're our friend. — Says Glimmer, pulling away from the hug and picking up the little one on his lap. — And I think we now have a new member in our best friends forever, don't we? — The queen spins around with the little one, making him laugh out loud.

— We're not friends. — she says, making them both look confused. — We're a family! The best family you could wish for. — She says, making them smile, tears flowing, and she hugs them again.

— Hey! There you are! — Swift Wind suddenly appears with Frosta and Scorpia. — We're going to Salineas for a beach party. Are you coming? — Frosta says excitedly.

— Just to clarify, it's a mission, not a party. — corrects Scorpia. — It seems that some ships have been stolen, and we're going there to investigate.

— Exactly! Just like old times! What do you say, Adora? Ready for an adventure? — says Swift Wind excitedly. Everyone looks expectantly at Adora, until she pretends to ponder, putting her hand to her chin and making her friends nervous. With a broad smile, the blonde makes her sword appear, cheering them up even more.

— And what are we waiting for? Let's go! — She exclaims with a smile, infecting everyone. " *It's good to be back.* "

...

After the mission, Adora returned to her room with the little one in her arms, who was sleeping peacefully. She put him next to her

on the bed, taken a quick bath and got ready for bed. As she lay down, she checked that the little one was all right, tucked him under the covers and soon fell asleep.

Adora woke up in a large field. I'd never been there, but I recognized the place. It felt strangely familiar. Gradually, she spotted someone behind the trees, slowly approaching until she came across a mischievous cat.

— Gotcha! — Adora jokes, holding Catra on her lap and making her laugh.

— Hey, Adora~ — How she missed that, playing with her like that, it's like they always do that. — Adora. — The cat calls out, staring at the blonde seriously. — You have to wake up. — She declares, leaving Adora confused.

— What are you talking about? I'm awake! — She insists, trying to kiss the cat, but she pulls back, making Adora nervous.

— Adora, wake up!

Reality?

[...]

— ... *Adora...?* — That voice... — *Adora.* — It's been a long time since she's heard it, apart from in her dreams. But it's not real. It couldn't be... could it? — Adora!

Opening her eyes, Adora was confronted by a feline figure calling out to her. — Catra? Oh my God, Catra! — The blonde screamed, scaring the cat and hugging her tightly. — Catra... is that you? I'm not dreaming, am I?

— Of course it's me. Are you crazy, Adora? Did you hit your head somewhere? — says the cat, moving away from the older woman's body and touching her head. A tear runs down Adora's cheek, worrying the cat. She pulls her into another hug, allowing her to rest her head between her breasts.

It's been a few days since Adora started having nightmares, and she honestly doesn't know how to deal with it. Everything is so new. Living on a bright moon is something she's still getting used to. After all, it's only been two weeks since Prime's defeat.

— Adora, are you all right? Why are you crying all of a sudden? You're scaring me.

The cat says softly as she strokes the blonde's face, but the tears that fall aren't of distress, they're of relief. A moment ago, she had been dreaming that she had lost her, not knowing whether it was a dream or a nightmare. Everything seemed so real that he was afraid. What if it was real? What if I had lost Catra? What if he hadn't managed to save anyone? Even after her master's defeat, Adora hadn't thought about the possibilities, and if it hadn't been for Catra, she wouldn't even be there.

Adora kisses the back of Catra's hand, taking the kisses to her neck. Adora throws Catra onto the bed and gets on top of her,

kissing her desperately. She returns to Catra's lips and sucks her neck again, causing her to moan.

Adora stops kissing Catra's neck and rests her forehead against hers, letting out a long sigh with her eyes closed, still immersed in thoughts about the dream; however, Catra begins to lose patience. " *She kisses me like that and then stops!* " thinks Catra.

— Adora, are you okay? — Catra asks, putting her hands to the back of her head.

— I'm sorry... it's just that I had a dream. A very strange dream! I lived in a world without you, and I feel terrible about it now. — She says, kissing her cheek. Catra scratches her neck with his claws, making her let out a heavy, needy sigh.

— Apparently you didn't meet anyone in that dream, did you...? — Catra teases, making Adora just laugh, closing her eyes and enjoying the cat's hands all over her.

— How could I? You're the only one for me. — she says, staring intensely into the cat's eyes. — You'd be surprised to know what happened in that dream, heheh! It was so real, I was afraid it really was. — Adora kisses her again while the other caresses the back of her neck, causing her to sigh in the middle of the kiss. How she missed that, that contact, those lips, being watched in that vulnerable way. She loves these sensations. How could she live without it? She couldn't.

Suddenly, Adora interrupted the kiss as she remembered something. — What is it? — Catra asks.

— In the dream... there was someone different, someone I've never seen before. — She comments, settling herself on top of the cat, between her legs. — I think... it was a child, but I don't remember seeing her before.

— A child? Was it someone from the time of the horde? — Catra asks, standing up slightly to take off his shirt, which actually belongs to Adora. Then she discards her blonde blouse.

— Difficult, you don't look like someone from the old days. But actually… he was like you! A bit different in that he had blond hair like mine and blue eyes. I don't remember having anyone like that in Etheria. — She says, kissing the cat and trailing her kisses down to the middle of her breasts.

— Imagine dreaming of someone who might actually exist one day? Or, I don't know, who exists somewhere in the universe? I mean, there's a whole universe out there, isn't there! Ah… *Adora* …!

Catra struggles to speak when Adora starts kissing her thigh, squeezing the other one. Adora leaves a mark on Catra's thigh, moving back up to her breasts and staring directly at Catra, who tries to hold back her moans.

Adora loves to tease Catra, playing with her breasts and provoking reactions by biting her nipple. Even with the rain outside and the chill in the air, the room remained warm.

— I love it when you get like this… — says Adora, massaging her other breast, making the cat shiver.

— You only like it because… because you always get on top and take control… let me take you… *Ahn!* — Catra's loud moans show his satisfaction, making Adora smile with pleasure. Having Catra surrender to her desires made her extremely happy, and although they didn't always have the chance to be together, evenings were the perfect time to give themselves to each other.

— Maybe I like to surprise you, heheh… — jokes Adora, taking off her panties and throwing them in any corner of the room.

Catra changes positions, moving on top of Adora, sitting with one leg on each side and allowing the blonde to explore his insides with her fingers. While Adora continues to suck her breasts, she slowly lowers her hands, making Catra impatient.

— You've never been a fan of patience… have you?

— You're just… w-winding, Adora. *Ahn!* — Catra squirmed, gripping the blonde's shoulders tightly, scratching intensely, making Adora close her eyes from the pain and pleasure. Although it hurt a little, she liked the sensation. Adora stops playing with Catra's breast and finally goes where she wants to. Carefully, she massages Catra's entrance, making her moan with pleasure.

If she were to sum it up, Catra would say that the sensation of having Adora inside her, moving and riding on her fingers, isn't just a relief or pleasure. It's like drowning in a deep, bloody ocean.

She loves drowning in this love. A love she has always possessed, but almost lost.

After a few more intense movements, the woman finally reaches her limit. The blonde takes her hand out from under her, throws her on the bed and gets back on top. She admires the woman like that, knowing that only she, and no one else… is capable of making her dive into this sea of pleasure and love.

— Adora… the child of your dreams, you said he looks like me? But in exactly what way? — asks the curious cat, still trying to catch her breath.

— Well, I'd say… everything! Hahah! — she replies, settling down next to him. — But especially in appearance. But as I said, he also had a bit of me in him… and I even think… I considered him my son. — she says, surprising the cat. — What's that?

— Nothing. It's nothing. — She replies, turning around, but Adora doesn't believe her.

— No, now you're going to tell me! — Adora stands up, making Catra turn to face her. — What's wrong?

— I was thinking about something… — She says, trying to hide her face under the sheet, but Adora pulls her back. — Do you want children? — The cat asks shyly. She had never considered

the possibility of having children one day, and it had never been a concern for her.

Over the years of facing the horde, including Prime, having a family had seemed like a distant dream. Now, however, she could stop and think about it.

— I-I don't know. I've never stopped to think about it. — She says as she sits on the bed with her legs crossed. Catra gets up and sits in the same position opposite the blonde, while the latter seems lost in thought. — But now that you've said it… when I was in prison, I had a vision of our future together. You have long hair, tied up in a ponytail, hah… just like mine. Bow and Glimmer were older and different, and I was wearing a white dress with gold details. We seemed to be preparing for something, although I didn't know exactly what. In my dream, the child I was talking about was also wearing clothes similar to ours. Small details…

She says, touching the hand of the cat resting on the mattress. Catra's thoughts are also distant, he doesn't know what to say about it, nor has he ever wondered about it, this was the first time.

— Catra? — The blonde catches her eye, trailing her fingers over her bare skin, making her shiver. — We don't need to think about it now…

She kneels on the bed, gently making the cat lie on top of her, resting her head on her belly while the cat strokes her loose hair, making Adora feel sleepy. Before closing her eyes and drifting off to sleep, the cat murmurs softly.

— One day, I want to have children with you. But one day, very far away, it doesn't have to be so… soon. — That's what the blonde heard, raising her head to look at her, but the cat already had her eyes closed. Adora just smiled and lay down next to her, admiring her before finally closing her eyes and going to sleep.

A family… that had never been part of their lives. Neither of them. The few friends that remained had something taken away or given. The real blessing in all this was finally being able to sleep peacefully, confident that he would wake up next to the woman he loved, and together with his friends. His family.

I still think about it

~Four months later~

— Can we play something else? — Catra complains after losing five rounds in a row.

— You just want to change the game because you always lose! — Glimmer comments, having fun teasing Catra. Although she could have won, she has a feline by her side displaying all her emotions, which makes the game a little tricky. She tried to push him away, but to no avail. " *The only way is to accept defeat* ", thinks the cat.

— Come on, you're always so competitive when you play together. Let's do something different! — Bow suggested, getting up from the bed and watching the two women on the bedroom floor; suddenly Adora appeared with a beaming smile. It was clear that she had been running a lot.

— Guys! You won't believe what I've just discovered! — She exclaims excitedly, infecting Bow, leaving Glimmer and Catra confused and curious.

— Well, if you don't tell us, we'll never know. — Catra teases the blonde, sticking his tongue out at her for fun.

— Come on, Adora, tell us! — Bow jumps over the girls, approaching Adora who keeps a big smile on her face.

— So, you know how Mara's ship broke down last week when we tried to make some changes?

— Not quite. — Says Glimmer, getting up with the cat. — You broke it playing with…

— Anyway! I've just spoken to Entrapta, she's fixed the ship. We can finally set off on a journey through the universe! — The friends are surprised for a moment, until Bow starts jumping for

joy, taking Adora and Glimmer with him. Catra, wearing Melog, stands back to observe their happiness from afar, with a sincere smile on her face. She sees the blonde celebrating for finally being able to realize her plans from months ago: to bring magic back to the universe, explore new planets, make new friends and live unique experiences.

That was exactly what everyone was eager to do. Etheria was safe under the care of the King and the other princesses, so they wouldn't have to worry about leaving for a while. However, something was making Adora pensive. Catra had noticed this strange behavior in her over the last few days.

Glimmer and Bow went to get some cake from the kitchen, as well as any other things they could find, leaving Adora and Catra alone in the bedroom.

— Hey, Adora, what's with the cheeky grin? What are you up to? — Catra asked, biting her lip as she saw the blonde sit down in front of her.

— Nothing. Why do you think I'm going to do anything? Although… it's been a while. — replied Adora, observing Catra's body, who was wearing simple but somewhat short shorts and a shirt (which she stole from Adora and will never give back), with a nice cleavage on the breasts. In the blonde's opinion, it was a lovely sight. She tried to get closer, and Catra didn't back down, it's not as if she didn't want to. Unfortunately, the moment ended when Bow opened the bedroom door, entering with a trolley full of sweets, followed by Glimmer, who was carrying glasses and a bottle.

After celebrating the big news with joy, Adora and Catra say goodbye and return to their room – once known as the “castle prison”, but now belonging to them. Along the way, Adora jokes around with Catra, always dropping inappropriate comments that embarrass her, which was lovely to see. After a relaxing bath together, the two are ready for bed, but Catra is still worried about Adora.

— Adora, can I ask you something? — says Catra as she lies down next to the blonde.

— Of course, what is it? — Adora replies with a passionate smile, although Catra realizes that something is bothering the blonde behind it.

— You don't know how to disguise it, Adora. I've noticed you're upset about something. What's going on? — Catra asks seriously. — And don't lie, or you'll go without sex for a month. — she adds, making Adora shrivel up like a balloon.

— Right, you've got me! Actually… I still remember that dream I had. And I don't know, I don't know what to do. Is this normal? Should I be like this? Thinking and rethinking about it…? — She says, leaning on the headboard with a tired, lost look on her face.

Catra remembers the blonde mentioning that it happened that night when he witnessed the blonde writhing in bed and crying in her sleep. She didn't understand what was happening and despaired when she saw her in that condition.

— And what exactly is going through your head? — She asked in a soft voice.

— In the child… in time… and in you! The days without you in that dream… it was a real nightmare. — This shocked her, because she had never seen Adora like this, so lost about anything. Even after everything they'd been through, Adora had always been able to count on her friends and Catra, but after having this dream, she noticed that Adora was distant.

Catra moved on the bed, sitting on Adora's lap with one leg on each side and putting his hands around her head, bringing the blonde closer. Adora couldn't resist and kissed her with affection, with longing, with passion and desire. Adora loves sharing her moments with friends, loves being with them, but between an afternoon picnic and the cat, her choice was clear.

She loves squeezing the cat's thigh, pulling her closer. That's not enough; she wants to feel his skin on hers, longs for a complete fusion. Parting her lips and inhaling deeply, Catra sees Adora impatiently, longing for the moment she can't wait.

— A-Adora… if there's something bothering you, you have to tell me. — She says, touching her beloved's face and forcing her to face her. — Don't keep anything to yourself. I'm your girlfriend, remember? — After letting go of her face, Adora deepens her hands in the cat's body, marking her with intensity, dedicating hungry kisses to her neck, making her moan with pleasure.

— I think… I'm going to make an appointment with Perfuma. — she murmurs, caressing Catra's body, who only agrees with a smile.

Catra inadvertently starts rubbing his intimacy against Adora, riding her while she kisses every inch of his body. In a hurry, she takes off her shirt to admire those beautiful breasts.

Adora throws Catra's body on her back on the bed, getting on top and positioning her leg between her thighs, squeezing her intimately with intensity, making Catra moan louder at the touch.

— You know what I missed most about this dream? — She said breathlessly, whispering in his ear as his hand went down to squeeze her breast. — *It was feeling you.* — The blonde comments as she goes straight down to the other breast, sucking it with desire, while her other hand pinches its nipple, causing the cat to squirm on the bed.

— Damn it, Adora… you're driving me crazy…! — says the cat, making her smile proudly. Although she was always satisfied, Catra longed to have Adora inside her. Completely. However, she's been reluctant, even though they've talked about it.

Adora presses even further into her intimate area, noticing how wet it is, moving her hand down to her intimate area, removing her panties and inserting a finger. Adora adds another finger,

making the usual vigorous movements, causing Catra to scratch her back.

— Wait… I want you inside. Today, please… *ahn!* — The blonde stops what she's doing and Catra complains. — Why did you stop? — Adora is surprised, she wasn't expecting this request. She gets up, removes her fingers from inside Catra and sits on the edge of the bed without saying anything. — Babe? I know we've already talked about this… but I'm ready. You don't have to worry about hurting me.

Adora remains silent. Catra crawls over to her, hugs her from behind, and gives her a kiss on the cheek.

— Is it okay if we do this…? I mean, I don't know if you'll like it. — She says, and Catra doesn't understand. " *Is she afraid I'll think it's small?* "

— Baby, of course I'm going to like it. Look at me. — Catra asks, turning Adora's face and giving her a brief kiss. — Nothing else matters now, love. What I want is you in me. — She smiles. — Even if it's small, that's not what matters, heh!

Adora arches her eyebrow and lets out a laugh. — It's not small… — Standing up, she stares at Catra and hesitates for a moment before finally taking off her pants, leaving Catra stunned.

— Wow… that's… more than I expected. *Wow…!* — Adora smiles shyly as Catra pulls her by the arm, touching her intimately and causing goose bumps. — You like it like that, huh? — jokes Catra.

— Catra, for God's sake! I -AH! — Before Adora can finish her sentence, Catra puts his intimate in her mouth, sucking it eagerly. It was big, and she wasn't sure if it would all fit, but she was willing to find out. Adora throws her head back, encouraging Catra to continue. Catra stops, stands up and kisses Adora. She grabs Adora's waist, feeling her innermost being hardened, making Catra notice and squeeze with her other hand.

— Who'd have thought you'd like that, huh, Adora? — Catra teases her before pulling her in for another kiss. Adora gently pushes her back against the bed, and Catra spreads her legs wider, revealing her wet crotch. She almost salivates at the sight, until Catra moans softly and Adora agrees, bringing their bodies closer together. As soon as they come together, the sensation goes from zero to a thousand in no time, everything is wonderful and Catra's moans fill the room.

Their hearts are pounding, and their bodies are damp with heat and excitement. Adora begins to penetrate the cat gently, but soon Catra reassures her, whispering in the blonde's ear: "Do what you want…"

Adora increases the pace, holding Catra's leg and placing it on her shoulder. Catra can't contain her moans, a little worried that someone might hear outside, but the room is at the back of the castle, so at most a guard would be patrolling.

Adora lowers her leg, withdrawing her intimacy from inside Catra just to accommodate her and penetrate her more intensely. Both let out a moan, resting their foreheads against each other, before she repeats the movements. Again and again, faster and faster, making Catra tear up with pleasure.

The blonde can't hold back her moans either, each thrust is a different sigh that makes her mind spin. Catra pulls Adora by the neck, scratching the back of her neck with his claws and making Adora moan louder, speeding up the thrusts until finally they both climax together. Adora pulls out of Catra and lies down next to him, panting.

— Okay… That was… insane. WOW! — said Adora, smiling with satisfaction. She can't believe she's been insecure all this time, that was the best thing in her life. It's not that she wasn't happy before, but it was different now.

— I told you… — mumbled Catra breathlessly, turning around and taking Adora's hand to pull her close and tuck her into bed.

— Wait, I think we'd better take a shower… — Catra looked perplexed until she followed Adora's gaze.

— Oh, yes… definitely better. — After a quick shower and a change of sheets, they finally lay down to sleep.

The next morning, Glimmer scheduled a meeting with all the princesses to finally discuss the big trip. Like their father, the princesses were sad, but happy for their friends. It was something they had wanted for so long, and soon they would all be with them on the next occasion.

After two weeks of organizing everything, the day of the trip arrived. Adora had never felt so nervous as she did at that moment, but it wasn't a negative nervousness. There was a lot of emotion inside her, and she didn't know how to express what she was feeling.

— Hey, Adora~ excited? — The feline asked, watching Adora organize her things (and her own, too, since she did half of them and then got lazy). Despite her grumpy expression, Catra was also excited, she just wouldn't admit it.

— Absolutely! We're finally going to explore the universe and restore magic to other planets. That will be…

— Incredible! — Glimmer and Bow interrupted, walking through the door together. — There's no point in denying it, Catra, we know you're as excited as we are, hehe! — Glimmer teases Catra, who just shrugs.

— Right, right, the ship is fueled up, Entrapta is with Hordak waiting for us and I think all we need to do is talk to the guys and leave. — Bow comments with a broad smile. — I'll miss Etheria, but I'm very excited.

— We all are. — Adora puts a backpack on her back and looks at her friends. They all exchange happy glances and leave the castle, where all the princesses, King Micah and Castaspella are present. Even Madame Razz is there.

The group hugs and cries at the departure of their friends, but they feel happy and calm. As they enter the ship and wave to everyone before the door closes, Glimmer can't hold back a few tears and is consoled by Bow.

The ship leaves Etheria for a new destination: the land of the Star Brothers. They made contact with them weeks ago, and it seems they need help to restore their planet, so that's where they're heading.

— Alright guys, from now on we're going to change the universe! — Exclaims Adora excitedly, sitting down in the chair that looks more like a throne (Catra joked with her about this, mentioning that she would do some inappropriate things). — Entrapta, did you do what I asked? — She asked her friend, who was already climbing into another hole.

— Of course! Hordak and I were investigating the First Ones' facilities, and we made some discoveries. There is a planet similar to ours, where magic has not been affected, and the master was unaware of its existence. It's called Eternia!

— Wow, almost like Etheria. — commented Bow while fiddling with the tracker.

— Yes, exactly! This planet was out of the master's reach, but thanks to the information from the first ones, I was able to discover its precise location. We can go there whenever you want, Adora. It's up to you! — she said cheerfully, although it was clear from the look on her face that she was anxious to go as soon as possible.

— As soon as we've helped the others, we'll head there. For now, our priority is to restore magic to the planets.

— And how exactly are we going to do that? — Catra asked, sitting down on the blonde's lap.

— Entrapta has invented a device that will help destroy all of Prime's bases. Now we must organize ourselves first. — She says,

stroking the cat.

Once they had left the confines of Etheria, the friends went to their quarters to pack their things and get some rest.

Adora is lying in bed, going through some notebooks full of notes and old maps, Catra and Glimmer are in the kitchen, and Bow is with Entrapta and Hordak.

Catra calls everyone together to eat and, as they enter the kitchen, they come across a table full of food.

— Wow, you made that? — Bow asks, surprised, he would never have imagined the two of them cooking.

— No, no, a private chef showed up here and did all this. — Catra says, rolling her eyes and sitting down next to Adora. The rest of the time was quiet; they ate, drank and then returned to their activities.

Catra said goodbye to the others and went to her room, where she found Adora pinning some papers to a board she had brought. — I still can't believe you make such a mess just pinning papers to this board. You'd better tidy up before you go to bed. — Catra scolds the blonde, who just smiles awkwardly.

— Relax, I'll tidy up. — Everything was very detailed. Maps, important information, some silly notes and next to it all, there was a photo of the two of them.

— When did you take this picture? — she asked, picking up the picture.

— I think it was on our first date. — she replied, picking up the papers from the floor. She watched Catra look at the photo in love, it was too much for her heart, and the blonde hugged her from behind, leaving a kiss on her shoulder. — You have the *cutest* look on your face right now, you know that?

She teased her, who just pushed her away, causing them to fall onto the bed. The two chatted for a while until Catra got up to take a shower, prompting Adora to join her.

This adventure will be the best ever!

It was supposed to be a normal day

[...]

The best friends find themselves on yet another planet, summoned because Prime's towers have been taken over by bandits. Together, they managed to defeat the criminals and recover important items for the city. In gratitude, they were warmly welcomed by the leader, who organized festivities in honor of their achievements. As they planned to stay in the city for another day, they took the opportunity to visit local tourist attractions.

— So... is this a zoo? — Catra asked, suspicious.

— It's pretty big. How far does it go? — Bow asked the leader. The leader explained that it extends into the mountains, where you can enjoy a beautiful sunset. The suggestion is to take an almost three-hour hike to the top, where they could see animals that are unique in the universe, ending the day with dinner on the mountain followed by a thrilling zip line descent.

— Let's go! — Shouts Entrapta at the head of the group, excited about her tablet and observing everything around her, until she is restrained by Hordak from venturing into strange places.

The friends walked for a while until they finally reached the areas where the animals were, and to everyone's surprise, they found one...

— What the fuck is that? — Catra says, staring at the long-necked bird.

— According to the map, this is the 'Ostrich' area...? — Glimmer looks at the map and everyone tilts their heads to the left, wondering what strange creature that was, until Catra, for some reason, approaches the animal.

She gets even closer until the ostrich looks at her, and the two of them stare at each other without even blinking, making the scene adorable.

— It's not so bad. What's up, buddy -AHH! — The ostrich attacks Catra, causing her friends to laugh and Adora to run to her aid. Glimmer keeps laughing and Bow doesn't let the moment pass, taking a photo.

— You took a picture, didn't you? — Glimmer asks quietly, his voice hoarse with laughter.

— Of course! We have to make a picture of it. — Answering quietly, they both smile again as they look at the photo on the tablet.

— Hey! I can hear you!

— Hey guys, what happened? — Entrapta suddenly appears next to Hordak. — Catra, what happened to your hair? — She asks innocently, provoking only an angry snort from the other.

— Long story. We'll send you the photos later. — says Glimmer, teasing Catra, who turns red with anger and Adora has to calm her down. The friends explore different places and meet various animals they've never seen before. It was amazing what they were learning.

Adora was walking alongside Catra, a little behind the others, who had already set off for the mountain trail. — Are you all right? — Adora asked with a smile on her face.

— Yes, why? Oh, no! There's still drool in my hair! — she says, desperately wiping her hair.

— No, no! It's just… I've noticed that you're walking slowly.

— Humph, you want to go fast, just go, Adora. You stayed behind with me because you wanted to. — Says the cat as she walks ahead.

— That's not what I meant. — Adora noticed that wherever they went, Catra was always distant from the others or seemed to lack attention.

— Did you die back there, Adora? — She shouts in front of her, snapping her out of her thoughts. Adora runs to catch up with Catra, returning to her side. Catra is surprised, but to cheer her up, gives her a quick kiss before following the others.

After a long 30-minute walk, they finally reached the top, just in time to see the sunset. The sky was tinged with orange, the weather was pleasant, and a cool breeze made it comfortable to sit on the grass and enjoy the view.

Catra moved away from the group and sat down under a tree, attracting the worried eyes of Adora, who knew that something was bothering her. She just didn't know what it was.

She didn't want to disturb the feline because she was sure she would be back soon, but her intuition urged her to get closer. She decided to get away from her friends and walk over to the sleeping cat, sit down next to her and put her on her lap. The cat is so relaxed that she wouldn't notice if she was being carried.

As she sleeps serenely, Adora can't help but smile in a silly, passionate way. It was just like in her dreams... in her dreams...

Months passed, and she still couldn't get it out of her head. She couldn't just forget it, because it wasn't just a dream, it was a warning.

A warning that if anything happened to Catra... she would be lost. This reality frightens her.

...

— Man, I didn't think she'd throw up... — says Glimmer as he and the others observe Catra's pitiful condition. At nightfall, they had dinner enjoying the starry view and, as part of the tour, after resting, they went to the top of the mountain to zip line down.

Catra was hesitant about going down, but at the insistence of Adora and Glimmer teasing her, she finally agreed. When she got down, she surprised everyone by running into a corner and throwing up all her dinner. Adora was by her side, massaging her back and trying to calm her down, but soon Catra was back to normal.

— So… how are you feeling? — Bow asked, offering her a glass of water, which she didn't refuse.

— We'll never… talk about it again! — Catra replied with a firm look at her friends. Everyone understood, and Glimmer apologized for the provocation.

After returning to the city and thanking the leader for the tour, they went back to the ship to pack their things and go to sleep.

— Hey~ you took too long in the shower. — said Adora, hugging Catra and giving her a kiss on the forehead. Catra just hugged her back. — … Catra?

— Adora… I have to tell you something.

We are a family

[…]

— PREGNANT! — Everyone exclaimed, surprised by the revelation. When she decided to open up to her friends, they thought it was something to do with Catra's health.

— Wait, wait! You mean… really pregnant? Like… REALLY pregnant? — Glimmer is the most shocked of the group, she had already noticed something unusual about Catra, both in her behavior and in the changes in her body.

— Yes… — Adora is still processing the news. It was a whirlwind of thoughts. *"How to deal with it? Catra is pregnant! How do you raise a child? What am I supposed to do?"*

His thoughts were confused and everyone could tell. Glimmer took Adora outside to talk, while Bow went to talk to Catra.

{Glimmer and Adora}

— So… how are you feeling? — Glimmer asks, sitting down while Adora stands with her arms crossed

— … I don't know! I don't know what to think! We've talked about it before, but I don't know. No… I don't think it's bad. But I didn't expect it to happen so quickly! — Adora paces back and forth, panicked.

— Hey, hey, Adora! Calm down! You don't have to despair like that, girl.

— I-I don't know, Glimmer. I don't know how to be a mother! — Adora lowers her head, until Glimmer gets up and punches her in the shoulder. — Ow! Why did you do that?

— Sorry, I had to! — Glimmer looks at Adora, who is almost crying. — I'm sorry… I didn't mean to. But, Adora, no one is born

knowing how to be a mother. It's something you learn over time, you know?

— But I… — She tries to speak, but is interrupted by another punch on the shoulder.

— I'm sorry! Do you remember how I used to be with Mom? — For a long time, talking about Angela was delicate, but it was always a topic between them. — I remember when one day I ran away from her through the castle, heh. I left her completely lost, until she stopped looking for me and joined in the fun. Then I looked for her everywhere and couldn't find her, which made me sad. I went back to my room, started crying, and suddenly she appeared and stroked my head, smiling. That made me happy.

— … *I'm sorry* … — These words cannot express what she was feeling. The day Angela left, she promised that she would stay with Glimmer; she promised that they would take care of each other, and in her dream she broke that promise.

What if one day she really does? What if, one day, everything she has dedicated herself to crumbles before her eyes…? Unable to distinguish between what is real and what is not. And that reality, the thought of one day losing her friends, losing Catra… terrifies her.

— Adora, no matter what comes, we're here with you. We'll face it together, we're a family, and you… you're my sister, Adora. And I'm happy! Holy crap, I'm going to be an auntie! — She exclaims, waving Adora off with a big smile, making her smile too. — So… how are you feeling? — *"We're not just friends, we're family!"* Whatever the reality, we'll always be united.

— … Happy, heh! I'm going to be a mom! — They both hug each other and spin around excitedly. It was scary, but wonderful at the same time. And no matter what, she had her family to support her.

{Bow and Catra}

Bow went to the girls' room and knocked on the door, calling for the cat. Without getting an answer, he decided to enter without ceremony.

In the dark room, he saw a pile of clothes on the bed and something moving underneath them. — Catra~ Hey… do you want to… talk? — he asks, silently approaching the bed.

— Get out of here, arrow boy! — she shouts, making him smile at the nickname.

— Wow! It's been a while since you called me that. And also, I'm not going out~ — he sits on the edge of the bed, waiting for the cat to come out from under her clothes, until he hears her sobbing softly. — You can talk to me, Catra. I don't know exactly how to help you, but I want to help you!

Finally, the cat emerges from under her clothes, sitting cross-legged without facing him. — I'm feeling strange…

— Right~

— My body feels strange… and I feel sick. — she says, touching her stomach.

— Right, and what else?

— I'm also very hungry and very, VERY sleepy. I want to cry and scream, but I'm confused! I'm not ready to deal with this! What if I end up ruining everything? What if I hurt Adora? I don't want to lose her! — While they were in Etheria, Bow did some relaxation sessions with Perfuma and, during that time, he witnessed the cat's therapies. It was sad to hear about all the difficulties she had faced in her childhood and how heavy her heart was.

— Hey! Calm down, let's breathe, okay? Here, come on! — He said, taking the cat's hand and sitting down in the same position as her. He started breathing and she followed him. They repeated this a few times until she finally calmed down. — Okay… that's great. See how much calmer you are now?

Bow and Catra had never really been close. In fact, it was surprising that the cat was more attached to Glimmer.

But it was in those moments that he wanted to get closer to her. Those relaxing moments of deep conversation and laughter. When they'd finished with Perfuma, they'd usually wander around the kingdom, visiting a few towns, and in the process they'd always talk about a lot of things that amused them both, despite their different tastes.

— … Thank you. I… — She tries to speak, but the tears come faster. Bow's heart squeezes, and he holds her in his arms to comfort her. — I… I'm afraid I won't be a good mother. — She says through her tears. — I don't know how to be a mother. I don't even know where to start…

— No one is born knowing. I'm sure we'll learn together. You and Adora are our family. We'll be with you every step of the way. I promise! — As he turns away from the cat, she faces him with a smile. After wiping away her tears, she gives him a push, just for fun, threatening him not to tell anyone that she cried. The two continue talking until Catra decides to go out for a bite to eat.

The next moment, in the kitchen, they come across Glimmer and Adora.

Adora and Catra stared at each other in silence, which made Bow and Glimmer nervous before they left, leaving the two alone. While Adora leaned on the table, Catra stood near the exit.

— Catra…

— Adora! — interrupted Catra, which made them both laugh.

— Sorry. You can speak first. — said Adora, sitting down facing Catra.

— … Let's be honest, Adora! We've never had any examples of motherhood. I don't know how to make it work. — confessed Catra, sincerely.

— So… you don't want to? — asked Adora, her voice hoarse.

Catra raised her head, stared at the blonde with her head down and, coming closer, lifted Adora's face to look her in the eye. They were both red and the trail of tears on their faces was visible.

— I'm not saying I don't want to… I'm just… afraid that I'm not enough for you. I don't want to lose you. — said Catra, being hugged by Adora, which made them both get emotional together.

How to be a good mother? How to make it work? What about the trip? What about the mission to help other planets? Would they be willing to give it all up?

Would Adora leave her mission to help the universe for her…?

— I'm scared, too. And you're not going to lose me! I'm sure that if we stay together, everything will be fine. — Adora stands up, pulling Catra closer, enveloping her in a warm hug. A few tears flow from Adora's eyes, while Catra sobs softly, hiding in her companion's neck.

— But what about the mission for the universe, Adora? — Catra turns away from Adora, wiping away her tears.

— Don't worry about that now…

— But Adora… the universe needs She-ra!

"The universe will always have She-ra… but it will never have another Adora."

The memories of her dream come back like a stab in the heart. She can't afford that; she can't give so much of herself to the universe and forget about herself.

— I know. But right now, my family needs me.

— Adora…

— Listen… let's go back, let's raise this child to have the best childhood ever. Let's give her what we didn't have. As for the universe: you're right! They'll always need She-ra, but what I want now is you, and only you. I love you! And I won't give that up.

— And the others? They've wanted it for ages. — She mentions, somewhat despondently. She can't help thinking how happy they were about the trip, and fears they'll be upset if they just come back like this.

— With the new anti-prime device, they can manage on their own. Besides, the other princesses also want to explore the universe. We can take turns. One month, one group, the next month, another group. Now we can embark on space missions! And with all the other friends we've made and the communicators Entrapta has created, if any planet needs help, we'll be alerted immediately.

Adora is convinced of this. She didn't have to do everything alone. She had friends, a family to help her. The universe is in good hands.

— … Are you sure?

— I'm sure! And I'm even more sure that we'll be great mothers! And~ I bet the baby will call me mom first! — She declares proudly, while Catra just pushes her away, pretending to be annoyed.

…

— Do you think they're all right? — Glimmer asks, looking apprehensively down the corridor.

— Calm down, it's Adora and Catra! Everything's going to be fine. — Says Bow, touching his shoulder with a confident smile. Suddenly, they hear a shout coming from the kitchen. — I take it back!

The two of them run desperately to the kitchen, only to find that the two women are just play-fighting. — … What's up? — asks the blonde, removing the pan from her head with a shy smile.

— You two are unbelievable, you know that? We thought you were fighting! — Glimmer exclaims, indignantly.

— Give it a rest, sparkly~ — Catra teases the other, who just rolls her eyes.

— Catra, you can't make too much of an effort! Take care of the baby. — Bow approaches, touching her belly and getting hit on the head.

— Don't start with that. I just want to sleep now. Come on, Adora! — She orders and Adora obeys, leaving her friends behind, hearing only laughter and comments about her obedience.

Bow and Glimmer look at each other with big smiles on their faces.

— We're going to be aunties!

Every moment

[…]

It's been three months since the best friends returned from their mission across the universe. Before returning, they completed a few tasks, such as improving communication with other planets.

Now, with the new equipment, Hordak and Entrapta are in charge of communication, while Bow has been assigned to distribute the missions. Over the weeks, they received requests for help and the princesses were able to explore new planets.

With the progress made in rebuilding Etheria, Queen Glimmer was able to rest for a few days, but her presence at meetings remained necessary.

Adora, Spinerella and Netossa have taken on the responsibility of training new recruits, using their vast experience in the rebellion.

Perfuma and Frosta are in the Fright Zone helping Scorpia restore her kingdom, which is gradually taking shape. Some old members of the Horde have returned and are also contributing to the process.

As well as the unexpected news of Catra's pregnancy, another surprise awaited the friends when they returned to Etheria: during a dinner on a bright moon, Mermista and Sea Hawk announced their marriage.

Since everyone was busy with their kingdoms and missions across the universe, a day of rest seemed a long way off for everyone except Catra. Her belly grew bigger every day, and she found herself constantly surrounded by Glimmer, Bow, Adora, Scorpia and Perfuma.

She understood their concern, but it was already starting to irritate her.

— If you try to convince me to wear that dress one more time, I swear to everything in the universe that I'll STICK IT IN YOUR…

— Watch your mouth! — Glimmer intervenes abruptly, before Catra says anything that might hurt the persistent Bow, who has been trying to convince her to wear a dress for three days.

— Come on! You have to wear it because of your belly. It's growing every day, and the way you're eating, it's growing much faster than you think. C'mon! Please~! — Bow tries to persuade her with a puppy dog look.

— No! I have my comfortable pants and you know it! You just want me to wear them to take pictures! — She says, rolling her eyes at him, who gives her a sad little pout.

Adora enters the room and is confronted with the usual hilarious scene. Bow holding a dress, Glimmer consoling her and Catra at the window with Melog frowning.

— Are you still trying this?

— Your girlfriend is so cruel~! — She complains into Glimmer's lap, who can only laugh.

— Yes, I know! That's why I told you to give up. — Adora said, throwing her jacket on the bed and letting her hair down. She doesn't usually let it down, but after a conversation with Catra and a joke from her about going bald before thirty, she decided to let it down.

— Come on, Catra! Just once won't kill you~ — he tried again, making the cat more angry. Adora and Catra stared at each other and, at that moment, Adora knew what to do.

— Okay, guys! I love you, but it's time to leave. Come on, kisses, bye! — Adora pushes them both out and locks the door, hearing only Glimmer's grumbling and Bow's crying.

— I'm glad you showed up. I was about to throw him out of the window. — She said, releasing Melog to go out onto the bedroom balcony.

— Well, he's right… — she tried to say, but Catra threw a pillow at her.

— Even you, Adora? I told you. I didn't…

— You're not putting the dress on! I understood perfectly. — She threw the pillow on the bed as she approached Catra and sat down next to her to enjoy the cool breeze and the beautiful view in front of them. Catra changes position and lies on top of Adora, who settles between his legs, stroking the cat's belly.

A slight smile appears on Adora's face as she kisses Catra's shoulder and moves up to her neck. — Your belly is much bigger than when we came back. — She whispers in Catra's ear, who tilts her head back.

— I know… but I'm getting bored with doing nothing all day. — Catra touches her shoulder, frowning.

— You spend all your time walking around with Melog. — The blonde moves away from the cat to give herself some space and massage her shoulders.

— I know that, but it's not the same as being busy! I'm just watching you, I want to help too. — Catra complains, getting up and heading for the bathroom.

— But, Cat…

— I know, I know! I can't make an effort. It's just… — Catra lets out a deep sigh. — I feel *useless* doing nothing…

— I'm sorry, darling… I understand how boring it is to do nothing. I nearly went mad once when I was ill. But patience is key, Cat… — Adora hugs her from behind, placing a kiss on her bare shoulder. — I've got an idea! How about you come and train the

new recruits with me? You're good at giving orders, hehe. — Catra hesitates, biting her lip.

Even though she wanted to do something, it wasn't exactly her desire. It… reminded her of when she was captain of the horde. Even after all this time, she couldn't simply erase the past. *Even if she wanted to* . — You have no other choice…? — She asked sullenly, going into the bathroom and leaving Adora.

The evening was quiet, but Catra didn't say much, just listened to the stories the blonde told. Always with a smile on his face, agreeing with what she said last.

— Hey… you don't have to go with me, we can find another occupation for you. How about visiting Scorpia and the girls? Maybe they could use some help. — Adora tries to cheer the cat up. She understands how difficult it has been for her and wants to be as supportive as possible.

— … I think I'll go there tomorrow. I haven't seen them for a while. — She says excitedly, leaving Adora relieved. — Adora… I know I've been in a bad mood, and you've been trying your best. Thank you, sweetie. — She kisses the blonde on the cheek, looking into those deep blue eyes. — Have you ever been told that the color of your eyes looks like the sky…?

The cat asked a curious question, which made her blush because it was the first time she'd heard that.

— You're the first person to tell me that, hehe… — She smiles shyly at the cat, who settles down under the sheet and turns around.

— I love the color of your eyes~ — she comments sleepily, making Adora smile. She looks out of the window at the night sky and sighs deeply.

" *In any reality… I might not be by your side, but in this one, I'm going to enjoy every moment.* "

The end is just the beginning

[...]

It was a quiet morning and everyone was gathered in the meeting room, until something unexpected happened. Catra's bag broke and now everyone is outside the room waiting for news of the cat.

Adora, trying to stay calm, stands next to Bow and Glimmer by the door, ready to enter at any moment.

Not just them, but everyone in the kingdom is waiting for news of the birth of the heiress of the guardian of the universe. As soon as they took Catra away, word spread quickly that the cat was in labor.

— Oh my God! This is taking too long. It must be the longest labor record in the universe. — Mermista throws herself into the chair, making Adora more nervous, receiving fierce looks from Glimmer and Perfuma.

— Stop it, Mermista! You're making Adora more nervous! — The two women scold Mermista, who just shrugs. She had the typical expression of someone who is disinterested, but deep down she was also anxious.

— Hello, everyone! — Castaspella and King Micah appear on the scene, surprising everyone.

— Dad? What are you doing here? — Glimmer rushes over to hug them.

— Well, we're here to congratulate Adora and Catra! We heard the baby was due today. — King Micah greets Adora, surprised by the blonde's appearance.

— What? The news has already reached the magic kingdom! — Adora speaks up, so pale that she seems to be turning transparent.

— Oh, dear… I think all of Etheria already knows about it! — Castaspella says excitedly.

Adora laughs nervously, sitting on the floor with her head down. She was panicking; as soon as Cat entered the room, she felt like her heart was going to stop.

Suddenly, the door opens and cries are heard. The doctor approached Adora, who stood up abruptly, maintaining a rigid posture.

Everyone was nervous, and the doctor said nothing, making the atmosphere more tense. — … Congratulations! They are two wonderful children!

Everyone is celebrating with hugs, except Adora. She's shocked, her mouth hanging open.

" *Two!?!* "

— Congratulations, Adora! — says Glimmer as he hugs the pale blonde. — Wow! Guys, Adora's crashed!

— No wonder, right… hehe! — laughs Mermista, followed by the other princesses. Everyone is happy, hugging each other and celebrating; the guards nearby have been instructed by the king to announce the news to the whole kingdom.

— Adora, you'd better go in. Catra is waiting. — says Bow, taking her by the arm towards the bedroom. However, as soon as she steps through the door, the blonde falls face down on the floor.

— ADORA!

~Two hours later~

— *Ah* … My head…

— Hey, sleepyhead! She's finally awake. — The blonde opens her eyes and sees a Glimmer. Everyone is gathered in the room,

looking at her with smiles on their faces. And Mermista and Frosta making fun of her.

— What happened? — She tries to get up, but can't, receiving help from Scorpia to stand, still a little dizzy.

— Well, to cut a long story short: you entered the room and found yourself on the floor. — Perfuma explains.

— The fall was so hard that you rolled over for a couple of hours, hehe! — Frosta says next to Mermista, who can't stop laughing.

— Ah, love~ It really does make you fall flat on your face! Haha! — Sea Hawk says excitedly, and everyone laughs. Adora, although a little embarrassed, can't help but laugh too.

— … Where's the… — Looking at the bed, she notices two little babies. Glimmer and Bow exchange a look, indicating that they should leave.

— Everyone, let's give the happy couple some privacy. Everybody out~! — Bow said, and everyone left the room, a little sad that they couldn't stay longer to see the newborns.

— Enjoy! When we get back, you'd better have chosen the names of these cuties! — Glimmer said before closing the door.

…

As everyone walked towards the garden, Scorpia couldn't contain her excitement. — It's so nice to see our friends happy. And these babies are just adorable and SUPER CUTE! — Her joy infected the rest of the group.

— I agree! I'm sure that when they grow up, they'll be adventurers~ And you know what that calls for? A song! OWWWW-

— No, you can forget it! Dude, how did I agree to marry you? — Mermista said, covering his mouth with her hand.

— Because I'm your predestined love~! — Mermista blushes intensely and everyone makes cute sounds, teasing the princess who simply makes the man walk beside her, ignoring the others.

Bow laughs next to Glimmer and notices that the queen is a little quiet.

— Hi, are you okay?

— Ah, yes, yes~ I was just thinking. — Bow looks at her with a curious and affectionate gaze, making her smile. He knows when something is bothering her. — Well… I was thinking about when it's my turn to be a mother. I've been imagining that moment ever since Adora told me about Catra. I was… happy! But also… when that day comes for me, my mother won't be able to witness it.

Glimmer comments sadly, being hugged by the boy, who kisses him on the forehead.

— I'm sure that, no matter when it happens, she'll be very happy to hear that she's going to become a grandmother. — Glimmer smiles and squeezes Bow tenderly.

— … I'm sure they'll look just like you. — She says, breaking the poor Bow and looking questioning.

— … Huh?

— My children! I'm sure they'll pull you, hehe… Why the long face? Did you think I'd have children with someone else? — She teased him, who remained still with a surprised expression. Glimmer kissed him quickly, while the others laughed at poor Bow, who followed them, all red and smiling shyly.

…

In the bedroom: Adora sat in front of the cat, intently watching her care for the babies. Her heart was beating so fast that she thought she might faint again.

— Do you want to hold it? — Catra tilted her head, admiring the red, crying face of the blonde, who nervously agreed to hold her daughter. — Here… gently.

Adora sat down next to Catra, holding the baby in her arms. She was shaking, extremely nervous, and the urge to cry again was overwhelming.

— I'm almost dying of love here, heheh! — she said, running her nose over her daughter's cheek with tears in her eyes. — Have you thought of a name?

Catra sits thoughtfully, stroking her child's head, while admiring Adora's care and internally amused by her crumpled expression.

— How about… Mila and Finn?

When the second name is mentioned, Adora's world seems to freeze. Her ears ring and flashes of her dream appear in her mind. "*This… is Finn. Say hi, Finn!*"

— Adora? — Catra calls her back, looking at her worriedly. — Are you all right? — she asks, stroking the blonde's cheek.

— … Mila and Finn… I loved it! — says Adora, kissing Catra passionately and accidentally making Mila cry. — Oops! W-What did I…

— Calm down, Adora. Just rock her to sleep. — She gets up with the baby in her arms, walking from side to side as Catra suggests. Finn whines for food, and Catra promptly feeds him milk. Adora watches the cat with admiration, with only one thought in mind. " *I love you* ." — What's with the face, Adora? You look like you've never seen my breasts. — she laughs and Adora blushes slightly, clearing her throat.

— Just thinking that this is the best day of my life.

I don’t know how to feel... But I wanna try

~In another reality~

It's been three years since you chose to stay in Etheria. It was still difficult to go out or carry out missions. Her thoughts were confused and, even with the help of her friends, sometimes she just wanted to be alone.

It's also been a year since she started therapy with Perfuma, and the experience has been very useful for her. However, something the therapist mentioned is troubling the blonde's mind.

{A few days ago}

— Adora?

— … Huh? Sorry, what did you say?

— I asked if you've ever thought about opening yourself up to new relationships. — insists Perfuma. — I know Catra was important to you, but imagine if you gave new people a chance? — Adora frowns and sighs. It was difficult, but it was something that had to be done.

— I'm fine. I have Finn, I have my family, I've returned to Etheria. What more do I need?

— Love! And I'm not talking about just any love. Passionate love! The kind that takes your breath away, speeds up your heart and makes butterflies fly around in your stomach. That's the kind of love you should allow into your life, Adora. — said the other, as Adora stood up in annoyance.

— Thanks for today, but I don't need it. I'm fine…!

“ *You're not, but if that's how you prefer it.* ” Perfuma thinks, watching the blonde walk away.

{Currently.}

“Let someone in.” She can't understand why everyone insists on it. It's so annoying when they bring it up.

She tends to get angry easily when the subject is mentioned, so to avoid any possible disagreements, Adora prefers to hide during dances. At the moment, she was on the balcony, enjoying the starry sky. *Alone* .

— … *It's so serene* … — She whispered, but her peace was interrupted by someone opening the door. Adora turned to see who it was and saw Finn, Flora and Angel.

— Hi, Mom!

— Hi, Auntie! — Angel and Flora greeted her, while Melog followed close behind.

— Hmm… very suspicious. What are you up to?

— Nothing… — Finn replied, receiving a nudge from Angel. — I mean… we were wondering if we could go to the waterfall. Do you mind? — The three of them made cute faces at her, who could only laugh at the blackmail.

— Using those baby faces is cheating. — She commented, ruffling Finn's hair.

— Mom! Don't say that in front of them… — He complained quietly, while Flora laughed. — What are you laughing at?

— Your baby face! Hahah! — Flora hides behind Adora, making fun of the blonde who runs after her, being held back by Adora.

— All right, you can go. But only if…

— Only if Melog goes too! — The three of them speak together, gesturing with their hands, just as Adora does. — You always say that.

— And I always will! Stay with him and don't do anything stupid or dangerous. Do you understand? — They agree, say goodbye, but before Melog leaves, Adora calls out to him. — Take care of them. *Please* …

When the feline leaves, she resumes her drink, gazing at the sky. She heard the children's laughter as they went out into the garden, and a smile grew on her face as she thought of how big Finn had become. " *And to think I almost left you…* "

Her peace is interrupted again, but she doesn't turn around. She just looks over her shoulder.

— Oh, I'm sorry… I thought there was no one here. — says the woman, but the blonde remains silent.

Adora felt the woman's penetrating gaze and decided to speak up. — If you want to stay, I don't mind. It's pretty full inside… — The woman thanked her as she approached and remained in the same position.

— Oh… nice to meet you. I'm Cait. — Her name wakes Adora from her thoughts.

— I am…

— I know who you are. Everyone knows the protector of the universe! — The woman speaks with a smile, while Adora observes her closely. With a beautiful body, slightly wavy brunette hair, a small scar on her lip and light brown eyes. She had never seen anyone like her in Etheria, so she assumed she was from another planet, since there were guests from other planets at the party. — The boy next to you, is he your son? — She asked, slowly approaching.

— Yes, his name is Finn. — She felt her gaze roaming his body. Not surprisingly, several women had stared at her during the party (one of the reasons she had also run away).

— He's very polite. And cute, hehe!

— Just don't go telling him that, heh… — Adora smiled, while Cait looked surprised. — What's wrong?

— No, nothing! It's just that… this is the first time tonight that I've seen you really smile. I mean, without forcing it. — Is that how she was acting? She was so absorbed in what Perfuma said that she hardly noticed how she was behaving during the party.

Adora put her head down and took a deep breath. Her thoughts were confused again, and all she wanted now was her bed.

— Are you all right?

— Yes, I just… I didn't realize you were acting like that. I… — She tries to find the right words, but fails, taking another sip of her drink and turning the glass over. — Anyway… I'll be right there. It's been a pleasure… Cait. — Adora turns to go back inside, but is stopped by the woman. The woman gives her a seductive but worried look. Adora is confused. Why the worried look? She barely knew the woman, and she didn't know her either, so why…?

— I'm sorry! I, uh… Would you like to take a walk with me? It won't take long, I just want to relax a bit. — She says, her face flushed.

Adora looks between her and the door, wondering if she should do it, but the woman squeezes her hand tightly. " *Is she shaking…?* " Adora thinks, staring at the woman who keeps a low profile.

— Okay. — The woman looks up and sighs with relief. The two make their way through the crowd to leave the castle, and before leaving, Adora looks back, seeing her friends waving cheerfully, but she doesn't understand the signs they make and simply ignores them, following Cait.

The two walk side by side through the garden. The party couldn't end soon enough. The loud music reached the garden and was accompanied by Cait, who hummed softly.

— You have a beautiful voice… — Cait looked at her in surprise, suddenly turning away to hide her flushed face.

— Are you always like this…?

— "Like this"? — The woman continues to hide her face, but Adora notices her red ear.

— I mean… direct. If you're always so direct. — Cait walks ahead, leaving Adora behind. " *Is she embarrassed? Hehe* …", Adora lets out a smile and follows her.

— Didn't anyone ever tell you that? — Adora walked faster, standing next to her again. His face is no longer red, only traces of his shame.

— I've heard it before. But it's different when it's you who says it… — Adora looks the woman up and down, her heart races for a moment and her mind scrambles again. Adora lifts her head to gaze at the sky, letting out another sigh. — You're sighing again. Is it your habit to sigh all the time? — She asks jokingly, but Adora doesn't answer and becomes serious.

Cait remains silent as she sits on a bench, trying to get rid of her heels. Adora glares back at her as she approaches and bends down in front of her, helping her take off her shoes.

— I'm sorry… I left a bad impression, didn't I?

Adora denies it, but honestly, she doesn't know what she's doing. Why is she there? Why couldn't you say "no" to her? Adora can't find an answer.

— I was just thinking. — she admits as she places the first heel on the bench and removes the other. Cait blushes again as she looks up. Every touch from the blonde makes her whole body shudder, and she'd be lying if she said she didn't want to kiss her. However, with that thought, another worry arises in her mind. The way the blonde looked at the party. " *She looked so lost and tired.* ", Cait thinks, wiping away her smile.

— And what were you thinking? — She asks without looking at her as she sits down next to her. Adora remains silent for a moment, making Cait uneasy.

— My love… — She reveals, making Cait widen her eyes and frown. Cait stands up in frustration, while Adora keeps a distant look on her face.

— So, do you have someone? — Cait paces back and forth angrily, but Adora remains impassive. — I was flirting with you all night, and I know you noticed! Are you the type who just likes to take it and leave it? I've had enough of these kinds of people…! — She continues to spit out the words, and the blonde just lowers her head, taking a deep breath before speaking.

— I don't have anyone, and I'm not like that! — She defends herself, standing up.

— So… why? — Cait lowers her head in tears, surprising Adora with her reaction.

The blonde sighs again, trying to find the right words, but as she looks at Cait, she realizes that there are no right words.

— I lost the woman I loved in the war against Prime. I lost everything that day. Even though peace reigns now, I'm not the same Adora anymore. Let alone the same She-ra that everyone loves. — she closes her eyes, and the memories of that day come back, bringing with them pain.

— You… what… — Cait hugs herself, biting her lip hard, scolding herself for what she said earlier.

— I got angry… I walked away from everyone and ran away, giving the excuse that I needed some time. But the truth was that I was angry. Angry at myself for not being able to save her. If I could… *I swear* … if I could go back in time, I would die in her place.

Cait listened carefully, feeling bad about what she'd said, but she had no way of knowing.

— Everyone always tells me: “you need to learn to move on”, “she's better now”, “you have to open yourself up to new relationships”, you need this, that, BUT WHAT I NEED DIED IN MY ARMS!

Adora let out a sudden scream that made Cait recoil in fright. The blonde held her breath with difficulty, trying to control the turmoil in her chest. Realizing that she was about to faint, Cait acted quickly and grabbed Adora, causing them both to fall to their knees on the floor. Cait wrapped Adora in a hug as she felt the other try to break free and cry.

— *Let me go…!* — pleaded Adora, but without answering her request, she hugged her tighter.

— If you could say something to her now, what would you say? — She asked, and Adora hugged her tightly, holding her breath before speaking.

— *Forgive me* …

…

After five minutes, Adora calmed down, but Cait didn't let her go.
— I'm sorry for the way I spoke. I was such an idiot…

— It wasn't nice, but it's okay. — She stood up, holding Adora's waist, bringing their faces closer together.

— No, I was stupid! I should have stayed calm, but I acted impulsively. You're a good person, and… I'm really sorry for your loss. — Adora shakes her head in silence. — Listen, I know it's silly of me to say this, and even selfish. But I really like you. — Cait moves closer, looking at Adora's lips with a certain melancholy.

Adora reflects, staring at her eyes and mouth. She thought several times: she reminds her of Catra. But it wasn't Catra.

Even though she was reluctant, her heart raced, her face flushed, and everything she had tried to avoid feeling over the last few years happened.

Adora slides her thumb delicately along her lip, observing every feature of her face. Cait entwines her fingers around the blonde's head, giving her quick kisses on the cheeks, forehead and finally... sealing their lips.

The kiss was full of feelings. It contained passion, longing, security, gentleness, care, fear... everything. Adora could hardly believe that, even after all these years, she was still able to kiss someone with such intensity. Their lips tasted sweet but bitter, their tongues danced in perfect harmony, while Adora's hands moved on their own.

The lack of air separated them, leaving them panting, and Adora smiled, for the first time, a genuine smile. Cait smiled back and continued kissing her, distributing kisses all over her face, while Adora hugged her tighter.

— Listen... I can't promise you anything. I can't guarantee that I'll live up to your expectations. But I want to try to let these feelings enter me again. Really.

— I understand. It's hard to open up to new people when you've been hurt so badly. The constant fear of disappointment, suffering, *loss* ... I know what it's like. I lost someone special too. And what's worse, I didn't even have the chance to tell him how much I loved him. — Cait closes her eyes, letting the tears escape. The anguish on her face, the fragility in her voice. And yet... — I *promise* to do as much as I can. I want to get to know you more, I want to kiss you, I want to hold you, I want to share everything with you, because I like you! I've liked you for a long time. — It was crazy what she was saying, but it was also so engaging that Adora couldn't deny it.

— Hah... Thank you for liking me. — Adora smiles shyly, letting the tears fall too, and Cait, unable to resist, kisses her again.

Adora was apprehensive, but as she felt Cait's grip on her, her fear disappeared. Her heart is racing, her cheeks are flushed and the butterflies in her stomach are dancing again.

— I'm afraid... of losing again. — Adora says, with tears in her eyes. — It's not easy to love someone when you often don't even love yourself first. For years, I've tried to stifle these feelings, to repress them. But I can't. I still feel insecure... thinking: *what if I'm not enough?*

— When I lost my first love, I was devastated. I tried to... *kill* myself. But then I remembered what he used to say. He used to say: even if you're unsure, even if you're afraid, if there's still a spark of love, then you have to try. Because it would be worse to die without knowing how it could have been. — Cait clasps Adora in a tight embrace, leaning her head against his chest. — There's still a spark. And it's beating strong...

— Yes, it is. — They pull apart, wiping away their tears, and pull themselves together. It had been a long time since Adora had cried like this. " *I think I owe Perfuma an apology* ...", she thinks, letting out a smile.

— So... what now? — She asks, shyly tucking her hair behind her ear.

— I guess we'll only find out if we try, won't we? — Adora smiles with her eyes, and Cait agrees, giving her a quick kiss on the cheek. After recovering completely, the two returned to the castle.

They separated, but kept looking at each other and smiling. Sparkle and Archer asked what had happened when they noticed the blonde's crumpled face, but she denied it, saying that everything was fine. And this time, it really was.

When the party was over and some guests were saying goodbye, Adora and Cait went outside to talk.

— ... So, if you want to...

— Yes, I do! — Cait replied excitedly, but then covered her face in embarrassment.

— Heh, all right. Let's go on a date!

The night finally ended and Adora said goodbye to the others, waving to Cait from a distance. Suddenly, the wonder trio appeared with Melog.

— Ah, so you three were wandering around again, were you! — Glimmer scolded the three, who just smiled awkwardly.

— Flora, darling. Your mothers are looking for you. And you, young lady, get inside, it's late! — Bow picked the other up and waved to Adora, Finn and Melog, who were already on their way.

Even after returning to Etheria, Adora didn't feel comfortable staying in the castle. So she decided to build a house in the forest near the kingdom of the bright moon. Not so far away, however, only the princesses and a few guards knew of the blonde's whereabouts.

Finn, on the other hand, loved staying in the castle. He was no longer as shy as he had been the first time. The blond was always out and about (accompanied by Melog, of course).

At first, Adora forbade him from many things, but after a few arguments that resulted in fights with Glimmer, she finally allowed him to venture out.

Perfuma was also helping with this, she needed to learn not to be so protective. It was difficult for Adora to let him go to school alone. She always watched him without him knowing, but when Perfuma found out, she scolded the blonde and prevented her from leaving the garden (Adora was tied to a tree for four hours).

As they return home, Adora remembers Perfuma's words: " *One day he'll want to leave, Adora. He'll want to explore on his own,*

and you can't stop him. Just be there when he needs you. Lift him up when he falls, hug him when he cries, and encourage him to keep going. Because you saved the life, he will live with pride. Just... be his mother. Not She-ra, protector of the universe. Just, Adora, Finn's mother."

Back at home, Finn throws himself on the sofa while Adora goes upstairs to prepare the little one's bath. Melog and Swift Wind have their own corner. Whenever they return from a mission, they come to check on Adora and Finn. So it's common for the house to be full of stuff (messy would be the right word).

When she came downstairs, she saw Finn hanging from the ceiling. — AH!

— AH! — Adora is startled and her sword quickly appears. Finn laughs out loud as he returns to the floor and sits down next to Melog. — Ah, crap, Finn! I told you not to scare me!

— Sorry, hehe...! — His sword disappears, and he heads for the kitchen. — Mom, who was that woman with you?

— What woman...?

— When we came back, I saw you with a woman. You even kissed her on the cheek! — The blonde fumbles, dropping pans, while Finn and Melog look at each other uncomprehendingly.

— ... Did you see that? — she asks without looking at him, putting the pans in the sink.

— Yes, everyone saw it. You were right at the entrance, Mom. — he replies, playing with Melog's tail. — Aunt Frosta said it was your new girlfriend. Is that true? — he asks and the blonde fumbles again, dropping two plates, but manages to catch them.

Adora stands up, embarrassed. How was she going to explain that to him? She despairs, banging her head on the sink. Finn arches an eyebrow and walks over to Adora, who is still banging her head.

— Mom, stop it! You'll get a bump that way.

— Sorry, Finn... it's just... Oh, forget it! Your aunts exaggerate. I don't have a girlfriend!

— Would you like one? — Adora quickly raises her head in surprise. " *Isn't he upset?* " she thinks, looking him in the eye. — Look, Mom, it's okay to be with someone. In fact, I was happy when I saw you with her. You seemed so... *light* . It was the first time I'd seen you smile at someone like that, and I was really happy!

The blonde is speechless and hugs the little one tightly, letting a few tears fall.

— I'm sorry, I... — Trying to speak, she is interrupted by Finn, who covers her mouth with his hands.

— I know it must be hard, and I know you care about me. But I'm not a baby anymore. You always say you want to see me happy. Well, I want to see you happy too! So, please, get that woman right away! — He smiled from end to end, wiping the blonde's face.

Adora let out the breath she didn't even know she was holding, smiling with relief, stroking the little one's head.

— Okay, I get it. And by the way, I think you're spending too much time with your aunts. Nobody says "get", Finn! — She said, standing up, while Finn laughed, teasing his mother even more.

Meanwhile, Melog watched with satisfaction. " *Catra would be very happy.* "

...

Adora took Finn to his room and settled him comfortably in bed, enjoying him as he fell asleep, sprawled on the bed and purring.

Adora went around the house, tidying up and collecting Finn's toys. After a shower, before going to bed, she decided to have a drink. It wasn't a habit, but when she wasn't sleepy, she liked to drink.

Adora grabbed a rather strong drink and went up to the terrace, where Melog usually hung out, finding the feline sitting admiring the full moon.

— Hey, buddy~ Not sleepy either? — She asked, smiling, sitting down next to him. The feline replied, something she could understand with difficulty. — Finn said he liked seeing me with Cait... but I'm not sure. I'm still unsure about it. Part of me is still worried about the safety of the universe. Another part wants to put it behind me, because I know the universe is safe. And another part... you know... — The feline stares at her in silence, letting her vent. — I think I'm getting paranoid. — She sighed, staring at the feline, who just blinked silently. Adora turned the glass over, swallowing the hot liquid in one gulp. — ... So, what do you think?

Melog stretched, jumping from the terrace to a tree, then to the ground. The feline shifted his gaze between the blonde and the path to the Velvet Glove.

Adora hesitated, but decided to follow him. After a 15-minute walk, they arrived at one of the former facilities. One of the few that was still standing and sometimes served as a tourist attraction. But this one is different.

— You made me walk all the way here. Tomorrow you clean the house. — The feline murmured, moving on.

Memories lived. Moments of joy and pain. All the feelings and unspoken words.

— Hey, Adora~ — The same recording again and again, repeated over and over.

— I like that silly smile of hers... — Adora pressed the button again, repeating the recording.

— Hey, Adora~

— Look at the look on her face, haha! It's quite unusual to find people with heterochromia. — The blonde leaned in closer, as if she were telling a secret. — You know, I loved knowing that you had someone so special. Even on nights when I wanted to be with her. I liked to stretch my arm out of bed, imagining I was holding her hand...

The feline yawns and lies down next to her, ears attentive to every word. She presses the button again, admiring the cat's manner. The short-haired one turns to her with a sly, friendly look. A captivating smile and the ears moving in an adorable way. And the sweet sound of her voice calling her name.

— Hey, Adora~

— Hey!

On nights like this, it would be easier to just drink and go to sleep. But whenever the feline saw her with a glass in her hand, he would lead her there to repeat the same scene over and over again. Even though it was exhausting for him – and for anyone – to listen to several stories of doves in love, he stayed there.

It wasn't his obligation to act like this. His responsibility was to look after Finn, since like Catra, the feline connected with the little one. However, he also connected with Adora. He also felt lost when the cat left.

That's why he enjoyed walking with her on clear nights. Talking about various subjects, sometimes without him fully understanding, but just seeing her smile was reason enough to keep going.

— Come on, Melog! — The feline is awakened by the lights going out. Adora was waiting for him at the door, letting him out first

and taking one last look around. — ... Good night, love.

Let's talk

[...]

Cait and Adora are going on their first date – and while on her way to the morning meeting, Adora was “kidnapped” by Glimmer and Bow to tell them every detail of what happened on prom night.

After she told them everything, they insisted on helping the blonde get ready for her date.

— This... is too much for me. — She stares at herself in the mirror. She's wearing a different kind of black jacket, boots, and black pants with chains on the sides. — Why can't I wear my jacket?

— Adora! — Glimmer jumps up, grabbing her by the shoulders. — You're going on a date! You can't wear that jacket for everything. Look at this outfit~ It's amazing and with a dark but seductive style, hehe! — She says excitedly, and Adora rolls her eyes. — There's just one thing missing...

— What's missing? You've already confiscated all my clothes and replaced them with these. — Adora says, turning away from the mirror and sitting down on the bed.

— You have to bring her something, don't you! Just a minute~ — She asks, taking a deep breath and letting out a loud scream, scaring the blonde. — **BOW!**

Bow suddenly appears with a bouquet in his hands, panting, and Adora can't help but laugh at the scene. — I... It took me a while. But... **HERE!** — He spoke loudly, handing Adora the flowers.

— I was really wondering where you were. — She says, smelling the flowers. Bow falls to the ground, chest up, and Adora just smiles. Glimmer finishes helping her by sitting behind her on the bed and applying gel to her hair.

— Now that I've noticed... you've cut your hair. It's really nice! This cut suits you, Adora. — Bow gets up, sitting down cross-legged.

— Thanks! I thought it was about time I had it cut. — she says, getting up and putting her jacket back on. — So... how do I look?

Glimmer walks over to the other man, helping him up, and they both put their hands on his chin. They stare at you seriously until they crack a huge smile. — You look amazing! Girls, watch out~ Heheh! — Glimmer pats her on the shoulder and winks at her, smiling.

Adora let out a relieved sigh and let out a silly smile. — You know... when we saw you with her, we were amazed. Even though we were always urging you to go out with someone. But now, we owe you an apology. — Bow says, and Glimmer returns to his side, staring at the blonde.

— I don't understand...

— Adora, every time we talked about it, we had a fight. We know. You started to hide when people talked about romance around you. Even though you wanted to talk, we gave you space... but it was our fault that you withdrew. — Glimmer says sullenly.

— We realized that we wanted to do it *our way* instead of just letting it happen. And when we finally got off your back, it happened! So... sorry about all the fights. We didn't mean to, we just...

— Enough! — Adora speaks loudly, startling them both. Adora crosses her arms, sighing. — Families fight, that's normal. We're never always going to agree with each other. And, yes, I was running away, but it was partly because I was angry with myself.

— ... You're still insecure, aren't you? — Adora shakes her head and sits down on the bed. — Do you want to talk?

The blonde remains silent for a few seconds before finally speaking. But as soon as she looked at the two of them, the words fell out of her mouth. It was a strange sensation. Like she was drowning. Adora gathered her strength and managed to speak. — I feel... I feel like I'm betraying her...

— Adora... you're not! You're just--

— Moving on? I've heard that. — She says, frowning. Bow and Glimmer stare at each other, walking over to sit next to the blonde, who keeps her head down.

They each sit on one side and lay their heads on her shoulder, letting her talk in her own time. They wouldn't force it, they knew it would result in a fight, and they hate fighting with Adora.

Last time, the blonde disappeared for two weeks, and they only knew how she was because Finn and Melog always told them.

— I'm shaking, I sound cold, my stomach feels funny, and there are a billion things going through my head right now. Am I being paranoid? Rushing? I don't know how I'm supposed to do this. I really want to try. But what if...

— Adora, you need to stop thinking too much. Okay, you're worried, but you're not going crazy. You're going out with someone for the first time in three years. You're nervous and that's normal! It's just feelings filling you up again. But if you want to control everything instead of just *feeling* it, then you'll continue to be insecure. — Bow said, touching his shoulder. The boy's confident smile is contagious, and Adora can't help but smile too, even with the tears that insist on falling. — No matter what you decide, know that we're here to point out the obvious. And the obvious here is that you have to let things happen naturally. Something we weren't letting happen... hehe! — They both laughed in bewilderment, making the blonde giggle.

Adora pulls herself together and stands up. The two of them look at her happily, and Adora turns to them, wiping away her tears

and smiling small.

— Catra loves you no matter where she is. And I'm sure she's happy that you're moving on. And I know we always say that: "move on". But... it's the only thing you can do.

The queen's words are like a sweet, refreshing tea. She even feels bad about the fights before, she understands that she just wanted to see him well, but the times when Glimmer would come to her house just to get in her face helped her to move on. The effort to help her carry on even though she felt bad. Adora is very proud of Glimmer. " *And I'm sure Angela is proud too* ." She thought, smiling at her.

— Be yourself. Be the Adora we've always loved and you'll find wonders along the way. And we'll be here to support you every step of the way.

— And also... don't worry about the time. We'll take care of Finn so you can... — Bow pauses dramatically, winking at Adora with a mischievous face. — Have fun until the sun comes up again~!

Adora shakes her head, letting out all the air she's been holding in. They both smile at her and Glimmer hands her the bouquet. They escort the blonde out of the castle to say goodbye. From a distance, they watch the blonde leave, jumping for joy that it's finally happening.

— What the fuck are you doing? — The two of them are startled by the princesses who suddenly appear, staring at them in confusion.

They smiled at them and went back into the room in high spirits. The others didn't understand until they arrived in the room when Glimmer finally dropped the bombshell. They were all happy and Frosta even suggested following them to see what the date would be like, but was reprimanded by Perfuma.

While the others celebrated the fact that Adora was finally seeing someone, with every step the blonde took towards her date, her

heart raced even faster.

She was nervous, she didn't even know what to say, let alone what they were going to do. She just asked her out without planning it. It wasn't her style. “No planning”. But she had to do it without thinking twice. Just... feel it.

As she walks towards the city, Adora passes a village recently built by a group of refugees. Some planets were deeply scarred by Prime's attacks and so had to be abandoned. So they are here, taking shelter in Etheria, which is now a point of peace and hope for the universe.

Some people greet her, bowing. She doesn't know why, but the people of Etheria have become accustomed to calling her: Queen, Adora.

Even though she didn't think it was necessary, she didn't protest and kept going. Further on, she saw two familiar figures calling out to her.

— Hi, Adora!

— Long time no see, girl! I like the look~

— Spinerella! Netossa! — The blonde hugs the two women tightly. Netossa comes out of the embrace, looking the blonde up and down with her hand on her chin and an amused look on her face.

— New clothes, her hair done and cut, a bouquet and also... — She approached her, smelling her scent. — You're perfumed! Adora having a date~

— What? Really? — Spinerella was surprised and very happy, leaving Adora embarrassed and scratching her throat.

— Yes, I have a date. I'm going to meet her right now. — She says, scratching her head and smiling weakly.

Spinerella hugs the blonde again, and Netossa just gives her a thumbs-up and a wink. The two women are important figures in the blonde's life. They helped Adora a lot when she returned to Etheria.

And even though she didn't talk about it anymore, she still remembered a mission that almost went wrong. A mission in which Adora almost stopped being who she is...

(Two years ago)

Adora was on a rescue mission with Spinerella, Netossa, Glimmer and Perfuma. A group of children kidnapped by bandits.

— I think it's this way... over there! — Glimmer fired at the bandits who managed to dodge, shooting at the queen, but she was protected by Perfuma. She used her powers to corner two of them, trapping them. Netossa and Spinerella together trapped three, but one was still missing and had run to the back of the cave, being chased by Adora.

When she thought she had succeeded, she grabbed one of the children who had been kidnapped, using them as a shield.

Adora observes everything from above, using the darkness to her advantage. The boy walks deeper with the child squeezing his neck tightly, making him cry. When Adora heard the cry, the anger she was already feeling only increased.

— Damn it, you stupid child! **Shut up!**

He threw the girl to the ground, kicking her angrily. That was the limit for Adora. Her blood was boiling, and her veins were jumping with rage. She was losing any kind of human sanity she might have had.

The blonde used her sword to turn it into a lasso, catching the bandit and throwing him away. Adora jumped from where she was, making the lasso disappear. The bandit tried to get up to attack Adora, but the blonde was quicker to dodge a punch and

hit him in the jaw with a powerful kick. He was already bruised, spitting blood.

But that wasn't enough for Adora. She needed more. He deserved more.

...

The child ran towards the exit, bumping into the other princesses asking for help. When the others arrived where Adora was, they ran into She-ra. But she was different, her aura was totally different from the She-ra they knew.

— Adora, stop it! — Glimmer tried to stop her from hurting the man lying on the ground, completely bloodied. It was a scene of horror. Netossa stared at his wife, who also had a terrified look on her face.

— **HE DESERVES IT!** — Adora grabs him by the collar of his shirt and throws him back against the wall, punching him in the stomach.

He spits blood and his face is so bruised he can't see. Glimmer tries to grab him from behind, with the help of Perfuma, who uses her plants to hold his wrists, pulling her away from the man.

He tried to get up again, indicating that he was still alive, making Adora even angrier. When Adora broke free from the two and tried to attack him, she was stopped by Netossa and Spinerella, who didn't hesitate to use their powers against her with full force, throwing her away.

Adora got back to her feet slowly with the help of Glimmer and Perfuma. Netossa captured the other one and put him over her shoulder to get out of there. Netossa was angry. Spinerella knew what was going to happen, and Glimmer and Perfuma were just waiting for the inevitable argument.

~In the castle~

— What the **FUCK** is going on in your head, Adora? — Netossa fights with her in front of all the princesses and some of the guards who are present.

— I was just making him pay for what he did...! — Adora defends herself, frowning. — They kidnapped children and that asshole even hit one of them. I wasn't going to let him go without a scratch.

— But that wasn't just a "scratch", you almost killed him! — Netossa shouts again, making the princesses more tense. — You lost your mind. You got out of control and almost killed him! And then you turned into She-ra to hurt him. And that's not the first time that's happened, Adora! — Glimmer opened her mouth to speak, but was stopped by Spinerella.

She may be the queen, but she didn't have the head to take care of it, and the two were older and had more experience. And at that moment, the two showed more authority and control over Adora to resolve the situation.

— ... You can't go around killing people just because they've done bad things. Even bad people deserve a second chance, IF they prove they can get it.

— He didn't deserve a second chance! — She shouts, banging on the table and scaring the others, but Netossa doesn't let herself be intimidated.

Netossa was about to say more, but Adora left the room angrily. She wasn't stopped, and even the guards were scared of the blonde.

Adora went back to her room to check on Finn. The little boy was sleeping peacefully in his bed, but Adora didn't go near him. Even though his hands were clean... the sight of his bloodstained hands wouldn't leave her mind.

So she stood there, watching her son from afar.

After a few minutes someone knocked on the door, but Adora didn't get up, she looked over her shoulder and decided to ignore it in the hope that whoever it was would go away.

To her surprise, the knocking stopped, and this made Adora suspicious. The blonde got up slowly and went to the door, trying to hear something. But everything was quiet. No sound of footsteps or guards talking.

— Adora. — The blonde was startled into jumping up and into a fighting stance, but calmed down when she saw that it was only Spinerella.

— *Damn.* .. how did you--

— We need to talk. — She cuts her off, staring at the blonde seriously. Adora had never seen Spinerella so serious. She had a look on her face that was so sharp it felt like it was going to suck your soul out.

— Spinerella... please, I don't want to talk now. — She said, walking towards the bathroom, but the older woman wouldn't let her.

— And when will you want to talk, Adora? — Adora sighs, trying to control herself. She was irritated, and Spinerella didn't fail to notice, sighing too and getting to her feet.

— I don't want to do this...

— “Do”? Do you think I came here to fight with you and turn the room into a war zone? — She asks coldly, but Adora doesn't answer. She had nothing to say. Over the last few days, weeks, all you've done is beat yourself up over the problems, as if that were the only solution. — But you're right. I don't want to do this in front of your son. Let's go to the garden. — She says, walking to the bedroom balcony. Adora hears Finn stirring in bed, going to meet her.

— Hey~ It's okay. Go back to sleep, okay? Shh… — The little boy was drowsy, but when he heard the blonde's voice, he turned over and went back to sleep.

Spinerella was still waiting for him on the balcony, and when Adora closed the door and turned towards her, all she did was use her power to take them downstairs. It was more practical than having to take the normal exit.

The two walked in silence through the garden, and Adora couldn't deny that she was slightly afraid of Spinerella. The way the other woman looked at her was so frightening that her whole body froze.

Spinerella finally stopped and sat down on a bench, waiting for Adora. The blonde sat down, suspicious of this conversation. What were they going to talk about anyway...? About what happened in the meeting room? About yelling at her wife? Or about the various things you've been doing on missions?

All the questions were valid, and Adora had answers for all of them.

Except for one.

— What are you feeling?

— What...? — She asks, squinting.

— You've been doing horrible things lately, and even though the other princesses are putting their hands on your head, it doesn't mean that we agree with what's going on. — She says calmly, but with a tone. — But today... was the limit, Adora. Hitting, beating, whatever you'd do before; nothing... compares to killing someone.

Adora clenches her fists, holding in air; her mind is messed up again.

— I know it's been a tough few days. Difficult times. But taking your anger out on the thieves isn't going to work. You need help.

You need to talk to us instead of going around punching any bad guy. You're not like that...

— What if I'm like that now? Huh!? I'm not wrong! They do bad things, I'm just making them pay for it. That's my job, after all. Protecting life!

— But that's not what you're doing. You may be She-ra, but you won't be better than them, you'll be worse if you go down this path.

Spinerella takes her hand and squeezes it tightly. The older woman knew it was much more complicated than that. It had nothing to do with bandits, or doing the right thing. Being She-ra or not. No. It was still about the cat.

When she returned, Spinerella and Netossa kept an eye on Adora. Every step she took, what she did, where she went. And this wasn't a request from her friends, they were worried about her.

Adora needed help to get back to the surface, or she would drown in a sea of anguish.

— Let's talk.

You and me

After that day, Adora promised to talk to her friends more. And thanks to Spinerella, Adora started going to therapy with Perfuma, even though she was reluctant.

It was difficult to talk to Adora, especially when she faced crises; at those times she used to isolate herself for days, sometimes even weeks. It was a complicated two years, but when Adora said she had an appointment, instant relief and joy flooded their hearts.

— So... Who's the girl? Have we met her? How tall is she? And the color of her hair? Is she older or younger? Have you kissed? — Netossa bombarded the blonde with questions, until a loud noise interrupted them.

— What was that?

— Relax, Adora. It's just Mrs. May. — sighed Netossa, addressing the elderly woman with the cane. — Oh, Mrs. May! I told you not to hit the boxes just because you can't open them! — Netossa ran to prevent the lady from breaking any more things.

The lady hitting everyone with her cane always draws smiles from Adora and Spinerella, who can't help but laugh when she sees her partner running to avoid the blows. The blonde, for her part, stops laughing when she feels a strange sensation. A pain in the chest? No, something different, something good.

— Spinerella, are you...? — Adora asks, her wide eyes staring at the other woman. Spinerella looks at her in confusion, but her expression soon turns to surprise, quickly leading her away.

— H-How do you know? — she asks, checking so that her wife doesn't hear.

— I don't know. I just... felt it. — Adora smiles small, leaving the older woman stunned and overjoyed, letting out a relieved sigh.

— Yes... I'm pregnant. But don't tell anyone! I want to surprise Netossa and the others. — Adora agrees, happily gazing at her belly.

— *I'll never see her like this* ... — whispered the blonde, who was embraced by Spinerella and allowed to touch her belly. The two separate and return to where they were.

— Okay! Posture Adora, you have a date. Go, go, go~! — Spinerella nudged the blonde with a broad smile, watching her walk away and wave from afar.

— She's improved a lot... — Netossa commented, approaching his wife.

— It's true.

...

Adora arrived at the meeting place and spotted Cait sitting on a bench. As she approached slowly, a young man came up to Cait and started talking to her. They seemed friendly, Cait was smiling, and for some reason, Adora was bothered by this.

She adjusted her jacket and hid the flowers behind her back. When she finally got close, Cait cracked a huge smile – a real one – and stood up quickly.

— Hi, you're here! I'm sorry, I think I arrived earlier than planned, heh... — She comments shyly, causing Adora to smile. “To think that shy woman was hitting on me at the party...” Adora is amused by this thought.

— No problem. So, I-I brought...

— Sorry to interrupt, but you still haven't answered me. — The boy speaks loudly. Adora watches him intently, and his alpha male attitude irritates her. He comes too close to Cait, who slowly backs away.

— Oh, I'm sorry, but I refuse. — She declares calmly and with a weak smile, but he insists.

Adora clutches the bouquet angrily, her eyes glowing an intense blue, and she tries to hold back, but when she sees Cait's arm, Adora wraps her in her arms.

— She says she doesn't want to! So why don't you leave before I break your ugly face! — She threatens him, making him recoil and swear at them both, but they just ignore it and go elsewhere.

The atmosphere became dull and Cait became discouraged. She had planned the perfect day, but if it had already started like this, what else could happen...?

— Cait? He didn't hurt you, did he? — Adora stands in front of her, carefully touching her arm. She nods and looks sad, and Adora, not knowing what to do, ends up acting on impulse and kissing her hand.

Cait turns away in surprise, her face red. Adora realizes what she's done and blushes.

— I'm sorry! I-I thought that might calm you down. I'm sorry, I didn't mean it, I swear! — She says desperately. Cait's surprise soon turns into a smile, and she laughs out loud. The blonde is confused, staring at the woman who can't stop laughing.

— Sorry~ Haha! It's just... that was really cute, hahaha! — Adora sighs with relief, smiling with her eyes. She had been nervous all day about this moment, afraid of ruining everything, but her laugh was so good that it put her thoughts back in order.

Cait stopped laughing, wiped her face and stared at the blonde until she realized she was hiding an arm behind her back.

— What are you hiding back there? — she asks, amused, tilting her body sideways.

— Oh yes! This... is for you! — Adora hands her the flowers, which she receives with open arms. Cait maintains an affectionate posture and a look so sweet that Adora almost squeezes her cheeks.

The blonde stays by her side, stretching out her arm to her, who doesn't refuse, entwining their arms and moving on towards a perfect day.

[...]

They did a variety of things, from lunch to a walk in one of the most festive cities in Etheria.

At dusk, the two discovered a field with a beautiful view of the sunset. Adora sat down first, followed by Cait. The landscape was magnificent and Cait gazed at it with a contented smile, her eyes conveying serenity.

While Cait enjoyed the sunset, Adora secretly watched her, as if admiring a unique work of art. It was an indescribable sensation, a whirlwind of emotions.

Even in the face of these disturbing thoughts, Adora knew she couldn't rely on Cait just because of her resemblance to Catra. Doubts persisted in her mind, questioning the veracity of her feelings and whether she was just trying to fill a void in her soul.

" *I'll need to talk to Perfuma* ..." She thought, letting out a sigh that didn't go unnoticed by Cait.

— You're sighing... is everything all right? — She asked, still staring at the horizon. Her voice came out slurred, as if she was afraid to ask.

— It's nothing. So... did you enjoy today? — She asked, putting her hands behind her to support herself. His simple, charming gaze left Cait breathless.

She just smiled, shaking her head. Adora felt joy, but realized that something was missing. The same feeling struck Cait. As they got closer and closer, the blonde moved slowly, afraid of frightening her with a wrong move. However, the sensation was so mesmerizing that nothing could divert their attention.

With their faces close, pupils dilated, panting and eager for it, the blonde tired of resisting, pulling Cait in and sealing their lips. Their tongues, as before, danced in total harmony, pushing them even closer.

It was so intense that Adora hesitated to stop. However, she didn't want to just use it to mask her own wounds. Cait deserved better, a better person...

— Adora, stop! — Cait pushed her away, holding her shoulders. The worried expression in Adora's wide eyes revealed her distress and unease. Their thoughts were mixed up once again. — I don't want our relationship to be like this. I don't want to depend on you, nor do I want you to depend on me, just because we've been through difficult times. That's not right!

It seemed that Cait could read his mind. This woman was truly extraordinary, and every word she spoke left Adora in awe. But the same doubts continued to haunt her.

— So... what should we be? I don't understand...

— Me neither…

Both remain silent, Cait gently removes her hands from Adora's, but the blonde insists, holding them firmly. Adora rose to her feet, bringing her close to her face. The hot breath, racing hearts and confused minds gave rise to butterflies in the stomach. For Cait, going out with Adora was like reliving her teenage years on a first date, showing all the signs of being in love. For Adora, it was an opportunity to allow herself to love again. Despite her uncertainty and fear, she longed to believe in this new love.

— I had already thought about it... I was confused and afraid that I was using you without realizing it. I want to be by your side because I feel good with you. I feel light... for the first time in years, or since I've been alone out there, it's the first time I've felt so good next to someone.

Cait remains silent, bringing her left hand up to Adora's face and stroking it gently. Adora received the gesture with an open heart, without any ulterior motives. It was such a comforting touch, so serene, that Adora couldn't contain her naive smile and let out a sigh. Of all the sighs she had given over the last three years, this was the softest, most peaceful, relaxing and harmonious.

Adora was at peace, because that woman offered the key to freedom that she hadn't had for a long time. She gave her the chance to love again, or at least to fall in love with someone. To move on, without leaving her first love in oblivion.

Catra is important to Adora, and Cait knew it. Cait's first love is also important to her, and Adora knew that. Two souls who have been trapped and lost for a long time, fearing the future. However, thanks to fate and the efforts of everyone around them, it can truly be said that Adora likes Cait.

Adora doesn't know how to move on... but she is moving on. She has moved on by choosing to stay with Finn. She's moved on by going back to Etheria. She's moved on by accepting help from her friends, she's moved on by allowing Cait to approach her at that party, she's moved on by listening to her son say that she should do it.

Moving forward doesn't mean taking big steps. Moving forward means taking the first step, even if you're afraid. Every decision she made, even with insecurities or the feeling that she didn't deserve it, gradually brought about a change in her.

Now she was happy, and Cait could see it all over her face. The sparkle in her eyes, the unspoken words in her gaze.

— I'm still scared...

— Me neither. — With affection, she hugged her, letting her rest her head on his chest.

Night came to Etheria, bringing pleasant weather and a cool breeze that swayed the leaves of the trees and the wide field.

— Maybe it's time to go. — Before they parted, Adora sealed her lips to hers, planting kisses on her cheek and drawing a smile of affection from her.

— Can we do that again? — The blonde asked with a silly smile.

— The kiss or our date? — Cait laughed at the blonde's confused expression, and she blushed in response. Cait kissed her again, pulled away from the blonde's arms and held her gift lovingly. — I loved everything. And I'd love to do it all again! — She said, kissing her cheek as she walked on, laughing softly. Adora remained in the same place, her face flushed, wearing a satisfied smile.

Strange looks

~Three months later~

Adora and Cait are firmly in a relationship. They went out for a month and after a lot of thought, Adora asked Cait to be her girlfriend. It was two months later and Cait was determined to prepare a surprise for the blonde, even though she had no idea what to do. Each suggestion that came up quickly lost its luster, leaving Cait frustrated at not being able to find something special enough.

Adora had been incredibly loving, kind, and thoughtful. She wanted to repay all the affection she'd received and surprise the blonde with something unique. But the question was: what could that something be?

Meanwhile, back at the castle, Adora was busy working on selecting new recruits for Etheria's forces and preparing for the frontline soldiers' first mission. A special group, chosen by Adora, Glimmer and Bow, to help the princesses on their adventures through the universe.

Even though Prime no longer existed, there were individuals wreaking havoc all over the worlds. Many had to leave their kingdoms and take refuge in Etheria, counting on the help of the princesses and She-ra to resolve the situation. However, it was impossible for She-ra to be everywhere at once.

So the front line became essential. They had all been trained by the blonde and were ready for their first adventure in space.

Glimmer was happy with the results of the last few years. Etheria had become a meeting place for travelers, always welcoming representatives from other planets. The queen never had a day off, but this made her happy, as it was a clear sign that Etheria was the perfect place to ask for help, a welcoming home for everyone.

— Oh, I can't take it anymore! — complained the queen, relaxing in her chair.

— I said we could take care of things, but you're hard-headed. — Bow teased his wife, who only replied by sticking out her tongue.

— Are you tired? I arrived today, and I'm already being dragged off on another mission! I haven't even had my coffee yet! — Mermista exclaimed, throwing herself into the chair next to the queen. They decided to go to the kitchen to get something to eat, while the others continued chatting. However, someone was silent in the living room. Everyone had noticed that Adora was quiet. Strangely, too quiet. So Scorpia, being the angel that she is, decided to strike up a conversation (after being nudged by the others).

— What's up, Adora! How are things going? — She asked nervously. Adora had an expression as if she had just killed about twenty people.

— Huh? Oh, yes, yes. This... — she tried to express herself, but to no avail. Are things really all right? Should she say “yes” so as not to alarm them? No, perhaps she should say that Cait had acted strangely and that she had screwed her the night before. She promised to open up to her friends, but she feels ashamed to deal with this kind of situation. Especially with Mermista present, and she would probably say inappropriate things.

— Adora, remember what we talked about? Let out what's bothering you. — Perfuma said, conveying confidence to the blonde, who let out a deep sigh.

...

— AH! But she obviously wants to have sex, Adora! — And there she was, being cornered by her friends to tell them every detail of her love life. Of course, Perfuma tried to contain them and give them space.

— Adora, have you had your first time? — Spinerella asked.

— We're taking things slowly. I don't want to pressure her or make her think I'm with her just for her body.

— Right! We understand that. But have you talked to her? Or is it just something on your part?

Adora hadn't really talked to Cait, for fear of scaring her. Even though they were no longer young people discovering what it was like to have sex, it was still difficult for Adora. And, stubborn as she was, instead of talking, she wrongly concluded that the woman felt the same way.

— Well, your face says it all. So, do you get horny when you're around her or when you're kissing?

— What? — Adora blushed intensely.

— MERMISTA! — Everyone scolded the woman, staring at her seriously.

— What? If you're not going to ask, I will!

— Calm down guys, Adora's going to die of embarrassment this way, heheh! — Bow said in a relaxed manner.

— Before we talk about... adult acts. — Perfuma said, staring at Mermista, who just shrugged. — You're at the beginning of a relationship. You don't have to worry about it, but it's essential to have a conversation with her.

— Adora, tell me, what does love mean to you? — Netossa, who had been silent, decided to join in the conversation.

— What do you mean? — Everyone looked at the older woman in confusion.

— I didn't understand either... — said Glimmer, sitting down next to her sister. Netossa stood up and addressed the group.

— What does love mean to you? Give me some examples. I'll start! Love for me is joy! — she said, handing over to her wife. Spinerella thought before she spoke.

— Love for me is communication. — She passed the turn to Scorpia, who looked at Perfuma.

— Love for me is mystery… — Perfuma blushed slightly, clearing her throat.

— Love for me is companionship. — Adora watches her friends carefully. What is love? Everyone has their own point of view. However, it was still difficult to understand. Nothing made sense in her confused mind. Is that so...? " *I can't understand* ..." She thought, letting out a deep sigh.

— Adora. — calls Bow, making her raise her head.

— What is love to you, Adora? We've seen many examples. But tell me, from the bottom of your heart. What is it, love? — Adora remains silent, reflecting.

— Love... it's like having a gun pointed at your chest. We always hope we won't get hurt, we long for a perfect fairy tale and a happy ending. But the reality is different...

The light mood quickly turns heavy. Everyone listens carefully to the blonde's words and, at the same time, is pleased. She is expressing her thoughts, something that has taken time to happen.

— Love isn't a bad thing, but it's dangerous in the wrong hands. I'm still afraid, but I want to believe that I got it right. That I won't hurt myself or her. Love... love is *everything!*

— Yes... — Glimmer rests his head on the blonde's shoulder, interlacing their fingers. — We're glad to hear you say that.

— You've grown up a lot, Adora. — Perfuma observes, approaching Scorpia, holding her hand firmly. Bow sits down next

to Glimmer and kisses her on the forehead. Sea Hawk, surprisingly quiet, hugs Mermista from behind.

— Anyway, we're all evolving. Life never stops, every day is a new lesson. You can't imagine what it was like back then, heheh...! It was hard to stay with Spinerella, she wouldn't give me a chance, haha! — Everyone laughed as Spinerella nudged his wife.

— That's not true! I just didn't trust you very much. But after our first meeting, everything changed.

— Huh, you punched me! — She commented, provoking more laughter. — Well, it was hard, but I wouldn't change a thing. That's what makes our relationship special. — Netossa kisses Spinerella and sits down next to her.

— Yes, every moment was special, and still is. And that's because we've learned to be honest. To tell the truth, no matter how painful.

— Spinerella is right. Nothing holds a relationship together like sincerity. — Perfuma comments, taking Scorpia's arm. — So, Adora... are you going to talk to Cait?

The blonde thought. What to say, how to act in this situation. Well, she'll only find out the outcome of all this by talking to Cait.

— I'll talk to her tomorrow.

— Use protection! — Mermista joked, being attacked by pillows.

[...]

Cait continued her search for a present for Adora. She had already planned the perfect surprise, but wanted to give a present to complete it. But as well as the struggle to organize the surprise, Cait found herself in a dilemma about what to choose.

The challenge was: what to give the *savior* of the universe? Adora could have the world in the palm of her hands, she couldn't give

her just anything.

— What should I buy... — she muttered to herself, looking at the stores. Cait sighed, sat down on a bench and checked the watch on her wrist. There were still a few hours to go before she had to meet Adora, but for her, time was flying.

— Hi, Aunt Cait! — Finn suddenly appeared, startling the older woman, who jumped up from her seat, holding her hands to her chest.

— Finn! Wow... you scared me. — she said with a smile, trying to recover from her fright. — What are you doing here?

— I'm with the gang. — he replied, pointing to his friends outside a sweet store. — And you, auntie? Why the sad expression?

— Sad? I'm not sad. — She says as she sits down again and Finn does the same.

— So, what's got you worried? You're making the same expressions as my mother. She gets like that when she's worried. Only her face is scarier. — She joked, imitating Adora and making Cait smile.

— Actually, I'm on a mission. I'm looking for a present for your mother. But as you can see, I've had no success.

Finn looks around the stores with his hand on his chin. The little boy jumps up from the bench, pacing back and forth. Melog suddenly appears beside him, saying something that Cait doesn't understand, but Finn understands the feline, nodding happily.

— Melog has found a place! — He exclaimed, taking Cait by the hand. As they walked, some people looked at them a lot, which made Cait uncomfortable and confused. What was attracting so many stares and whispers?

That's when she realized. Finn was She-ra's son, and she was walking hand in hand with him as if he were her own. The little

one followed happily, and didn't seem to notice the stares. Melog walked a little ahead, just as nonchalantly.

Perhaps it was just his imagination. After so many things in the past, any gesture, laugh or whisper made his heart race. His breathing seemed to fail, giving him the feeling that his heart could leap out at any moment. It sounded cold and his head began to spin.

" *No, no, no...!* " Cait let go of Finn's hand, wiping the sweat from her face, rubbing her eyelids hard. " *Please... not again. Not again! Not again!* " Her heart squeezed in her chest, the pain was intense, drowning out all the surrounding sounds, leaving only a shrill hum.

— Aunt...? — Finn called out, but she couldn't hear him; the ringing enveloped her thoughts. Some people looked confused, perhaps worried, which only made her more anxious. — Auntie? What's wrong? Why did it stop? Auntie?! Auntie!

Her legs go weak, she feels like she's going to fall, so she kneels on the floor with Finn's help. Melog licks her hand, but she doesn't react, her breathing stops again, her head is throbbing hard, her heart is racing so fast it feels like it's going to tear out of her chest. Her hands start to shake, worrying Finn even more. She can't keep her eyes open.

" *Close your eyes. It's going to be okay. It's going to be okay.* "

Sometimes...

[...]

— ... So, in short, that's what the doctor said. — The queen whispers so as not to wake Cait.

Cait was still asleep from the moment she was rescued until now. The doctor carried out all the possible tests and came to a conclusion: an eating disorder.

— I had already noticed it, but I didn't think it was so serious. — Adora comments, watching the woman on the bed.

— She never mentioned anything to you? — Bow asks, and Adora nods as she approaches Cait and sits on the edge of the bed.

— Whenever we went out together... or even on our first date, she barely touched the food. It was strange, but I avoided meddling. — Adora held her hand, which was cold, and squeezed it firmly.

Although she appeared to be asleep, Cait was already awake. Then, after a few seconds of silence in the room, she decided to speak. When she opened her eyes, she saw Adora with her head down, Glimmer sitting in a chair next to the bed and Bow leaning against the window with a worried expression.

— ... Wow, what a wake atmosphere, heh... — she joked, trying to lighten the mood. Adora was stunned and approached. Glimmer and Bow also approached.

— How are you feeling? — asked Adora, pushing back a lock of her hair and tucking it behind her ear.

— Pretty broken... my back hurts, but I'm fine. — she smiled, but they continued to look worried. — I'm serious. I'm fine. — She insisted, but it was no use. Glimmer took over the conversation and got straight to the point.

— Cait... I have a question to ask you, and as your queen, I ask you to be honest with me. — Cait raised an eyebrow, waiting for her to speak. — Cait... have you eaten anything from yesterday to today? — Cait hesitates to answer. Then she takes a breath, stands up a little and leans against the headboard.

— No. I've hardly eaten anything. I think...

— What? — Adora frowns, angry and worried. She doesn't know how to feel at the moment.

— Why not, Cait? — Bow asks.

— I don't know. I get like that sometimes. I thought it was no big deal. — The three of them stare at each other, sighing. — How... how did I get here?

— Melog came to me and, when we arrived, you were on the floor, and Finn kept calling you.

— Finn? *I* ... I'm sorry, Adora. I don't know why. I've always been like this, and I've never fainted like this. — She curls up between the sheets.

— Not just a faint, Cait. You need to eat well, or this will harm you in the future! — Glimmer scolds the brunette, who just lowers her head. — Cait... as well as being your queen, I'm your friend. We're a family, and you're part of it now. So please, I'm asking you... promise me that you'll eat better from now on.

She says, approaching and sitting on the edge of the bed. Adora just watches, getting up.

— I-I promise to try. — She smiles shyly at the queen, hugging her tightly. Bow sits down on the other side, joining in the hug, but Adora remains standing.

— It's getting late. For safety's sake, perhaps it would be better if you stayed here tonight. — suggested the queen, but Cait politely refused.

— No... I've overstayed out of hospitality. — she replied, and Adora frowned. Cait gave her a sideways glance, aware that the blonde wanted to express something.

— Stay with me. — Adora finally said, staring intensely at the woman. Her voice contained no malice, only the desire to stay close to Cait in order to protect her. Glimmer and Bow realized this right away, but Cait didn't take it the same way. They stood up and followed the two women out of the room.

As they left the castle, Adora and Cait had little conversation. They both noticed Cait's anxiety, and Adora kept insisting that she stay at her house.

" *Should we say something?* " — Bow discreetly asked his wife, who just shrugged in response. After so long, they communicated only with glances, making it a habit.

"*Better not. Those two need some time. And I have no idea what Adora is planning, but I don't think it's 'it'. I mean... we've talked about it, but, like, it's not the right time.*"

Approaching the entrance, Bow just snorted and scratched his head. It had been a long and tiring day, and after this surprise, all he wanted to do was sleep.

— Thank you so much for everything, Queen Glimmer. I honestly don't know how to repay you. — She says, shaking the other woman's hand with a sincere smile.

— There's no need to be so formal. And there's no need to reciprocate either, it was from the heart. I... was really worried about you. And believe me, after all these years of surprises, I kind of want a break, hehe… — She says, looking at Adora. Cait laughs and shakes her head, hugging Bow and Glimmer goodbye.

Adora waved from afar, leaving with Cait to go home. Silence prevailed along the way. Adora slowed down to keep up with Cait, who seemed to stagger at every moment. The idea of carrying her

crossed the blonde's mind, but she quickly stopped herself, aware that she didn't want to give her the wrong impression.

The journey was long and Cait was almost asleep as she walked. " *Shall I...?"* thought the blonde, staring at the woman. At one point, Cait tripped over a stone and almost fell backwards, only to be promptly supported by Adora.

— Are you all right? — She asked worriedly.

— Yes, yes, I'm fine... I'm sorry, I didn't see the stone. — replied Cait, straightening up and still feeling sleepy. Adora, after hesitating, finally made up her mind.

— Cait...!

— Mm... Hey! What did you...? — Cait asked, surprised.

— I'm going to carry you. So... relax a bit, when we get there, I'll wake you up. — She said, cradling her in her arms. Cait assessed the situation, but her head was so tired that she just obeyed, giving in to sleep.

[...]

When she got home, Adora couldn't wake Cait. She could have, but she chose to take her to her room and let her rest.

Adora was restless, but she couldn't force her to talk about her problems. She knew from experience that it could lead to an argument, and they'd never fought before, it wouldn't change now. Adora just sat on the edge of the bed, watching Cait sleep. " *She has long eyelashes.* .." she thought, stroking her cheek.

Adora sighed and got up to leave the room. Outside, she found Finn sitting on the stairs, his head down.

— Finn? — Adora said, walking down the stairs towards the blond. She touched his shoulder, trying to wake him up, but he remained unresponsive. When she goes to call him again, the little man's

body tilts forward, but luckily Adora catches up with him. "*He's asleep. I think he heard when we came in. Has he been waiting all this time?*" she wonders as she takes the little one to his room.

Adora tucks Finn into bed, quietly collecting the toys scattered around the room, and then heads back downstairs. Melog and Swift Wind weren't home, so everything was quiet. The house was quiet.

Very... very quiet.

Butterflies

The next morning, Etheria woke up to heavy rain. Adora prepared breakfast and went to Finn's room to wake him up. She then went to her room to wake Cait. When she opened the door, she saw her.

— Hi! You're awake... I thought you were still asleep. — she said, stepping aside to let her pass. Cait's expression was downcast, but she just forced a smile and shook her head. Adora watched her walk down the stairs and, before going on, closed her bedroom door, banging her head on it.

— I'll never understand your habit of banging your head on things... — Finn said, startling the blonde.

— Oh, God! I told you not to show up all of a sudden! — scolded him, who just shrugged. "*Wait... Does Finn know Cait's here?*" she thought, hurrying downstairs. Adora jumped down the last step and faced the living room. When she looked at the door, she saw Finn hugging Cait.

— Finn, I'm sorry. I didn't mean to scare you.

— I thought... I thought you... — He was sobbing heavily, struggling to speak. Adora approached in silence, Cait stared at the blonde and sighed, bending down to hug the little boy who clung to her neck.

— I'm really sorry... I didn't mean to scare you. Can you forgive me? — she asked, stroking his back. Finn sobbed a little before pulling away, wiping away his tears.

— I can... but only if you stay for coffee! — Finn grabbed her neck again, patting her back. — I'm sorry too... I should have realized that you weren't well.

— It's not your fault... I just felt bad because... — Cait interrupted, directing her gaze at Adora. She stood up while

smoothing the little one's hair, letting out another sigh. — I think it was hunger. I haven't eaten properly in the last few days.

— Lucky for you, mommy prepared a lot of food! — He exclaimed excitedly, taking her hand and leading her to sit down at the table.

...

" *She was going to leave... without telling me?"*

" *She was going to leave me...!"*

" *Why...?"*

— Adora? Are you all right? — She asked, touching her hand as Adora walked away to finish the dishes. Cait bit her lip nervously, but she understands what this is all about. — Listen... I wasn't leaving, if that's what you think. I just...

— 'Just' what? — She retorted, slightly irritated. Cait was surprised, her eyes widening. Adora, realizing what she had done, turned around, lowered her head and sighed deeply. — I'm sorry... I'm just worried. — Cait approached her and hugged her from behind, releasing all her tiredness in a single sigh.

— I didn't want to tell you, but... I've prepared a surprise for you. For our two months together. I wanted to buy you something special, but I couldn't find anything.

— What? Why? — The blonde asked, getting out of her arms and staring at her.

— Because you deserve it! I... I thought that, by doing this, I'd be giving back a little for how much you do for me. Gee... you're amazing! I wanted you to relax a bit, but I ended up making you worry about me.

— Do you think I do this to win an award? I like looking after you, because then I know I really care about you. And I do! — Your words take Cait by surprise. — And just to be clear, I haven't

forgotten our anniversary. I wanted to do something for you too, but I'm not good at surprises, hehe...

— Aren't you good? I was almost killing myself to organize the perfect surprise and now... — She stopped, looking out of the window. — The surprise must be underwater. — Adora laughed, making her laugh too.

— At least you tried. Look, I don't want you to put so much effort into these things. Just being by my side is enough. I appreciate it if you do, but between a big surprise and a night with you, I'd rather have a night with you. — Adora laughs and Cait turns away, embarrassed.

— I still don't know if you're doing this on purpose or not... — she said, covering her face with her hands.

— Doing what? — The blonde asked innocently, and Cait shook her head, wrapping her arms around her neck and kissing her cheek. Adora smiled shyly, holding her waist, hiding her face in the crook of her neck. Cait let her rest, bringing their bodies closer together in a warm embrace.

They stayed there, wrapped in that bubble, between confused emotions and a burning passion. Finn came down the stairs to the scene and smiled softly. Melog followed close behind, and the blond turned around with his index finger to his lips, asking for silence. They were trying to leave discreetly, but the two had already noticed their presence.

— And where do you think you're going? — Adora asked, looking over her shoulder.

— *Crap!* — he grumbled, making a beak. Adora rolled her eyes at him with a small smile and sighed softly, giving in to the little one's wishes.

— You can go! But you have to stay in the castle. Don't go off somewhere dangerous. Do you understand? — He agrees, mounting Melog and then disappearing. — He always does that

thing of trying to sneak out. As if asking me was so difficult! — She says, frowning, making Cait laugh.

— Think about it another way. Wouldn't you do the same if you were his age? — She asks, amused, wrapping her arms around the blonde's waist.

— No! I wasn't like that... — " *Catra was* " thinks the blonde, putting her chin on Cait's head and letting out a long sigh. — Are you going to sleep here tonight too? — She asks anxiously.

— This rain isn't going to stop now, and I doubt it ever will, so... Yes! — she replies, breaking away from the blonde and going to sit on the sofa, picking up a book to read, leaving Adora to finish the dishes.

~In the castle~

— Finn, darling! — Calls the queen to the little one as soon as she sees him come through the door.

— Hi, auntie. How are you? — She asks, after releasing herself from the older woman's embrace.

— I'm fine. But I'd like to know how things are going at your house. Is Cait still there? — They walk together down the corridor to the other side of the castle, where the playroom is. (The playroom was built to keep the children at home in case they needed to go out on missions.)

— Yes, she is. She seems to be better. I was scared... — He says sulkily, and Glimmer strokes his head, patting it.

— Don't worry so much about it. I was scared too, but I'm glad she's okay. It eases my heart. — When they reach the living room, Glimmer opens the door for the little one to enter, dodging a ball of mud.

— Oops...! — The queen looks at the twins – children of Mermista and Sea Hawk – with a serious face. — Sorry, auntie!

— What did I say about playing with dirt inside the castle? Where's Ana? — She looked across the room for the new governess, suspended and tied by several vines. — Ah, children! Is this serious? That's the third time this week! — She scolded the little ones, who just bowed their heads. — Sorry, Ana... I don't know how to deal with these children anymore.

— Don't worry, Queen Glimmer. I confess I appreciate their energy. But I'd rather not be locked up like this again. — The woman says, staring at Flora and the twins. The three apologize and go back to playing.

While talking to Ana, Finn climbs the tree (yes, there is a tree inside the castle), with Melog, looking out, until Flora and Angel join him.

— Hi, Finn. How are you? — Angel asks, sitting down opposite him.

— You're so quiet today... I didn't even think you'd come because of the bad weather. — Flora commented, approaching him. The little boy remained silent, staring out of the window at the rain, and let out a deep sigh.

— I'm still thinking about what happened to Aunt Cait. I feel... *guilty* ... — He said, lowering his head and hugging his legs. Flora and Angel exchanged worried glances, not knowing what to say, they just hugged the blonde.

...

At home, Cait was reading her book while Adora went over some documents she had brought from the castle. It wasn't much, but the blonde read each line carefully. Cait watched Adora discreetly, glancing at her every ten seconds, thinking of the right words to start a conversation. Actually, to start a conversation that they should have already had. This had been causing her anxiety over the last few days.

Two months and they still hadn't progressed to anything more than caresses and kisses. She didn't want to be hasty, but it wasn't her who was impatient. It was her body that was. Every move the blonde made, no matter how simple, left her confused. How could a woman touch you so much without even saying a word? Was she under some kind of spell? She didn't know for sure. The only certainty was that the woman in front of her was awakening needs in her body that she couldn't solve alone.

— Adora.

— Um...? — Adora said, without looking away from the papers. Cait closes the book, marking the page to continue later, and sits up straight, clearing her throat.

— I wanted to... talk to you... — she says, swallowing.

— About what? — she asks, still concentrating on the papers, annoying the brunette a little.

— Could I have some of your attention? Please. — she asks, making her finally take her eyes off the papers.

— Oh, yes... sorry. What do you need? — She asks as she puts the papers on the table.

" *I need you...* " She thought and quickly reprimanded herself for such thoughts. Adora raised an eyebrow and sat down, moving closer. Cait avoided looking her in the eye, for fear that this would make her give in to her madness, and she didn't want to seem so desperate.

— Cait~? — She calls her name as she tucks a few unruly locks behind her ear, moving closer until their foreheads touch. — What do you want to talk about? — Cait tries to back away slowly.

— Well... about the anniversary, actually, I had planned something that... I mean, I... well, I planned... — Cait fumbles over her words, blushing slightly, and Adora smiles, thinking it's cute, and kisses her. Surprised, she ends up pushing Adora, who doesn't

react. — I'm sorry! It was reflex! — She apologizes, bringing Adora back close, and Adora can only laugh. — Why are you laughing? — Cait asks, slightly frustrated.

— Oh, no, nothing... it's just that you've turned red, hehe! You looked surprised, are you worried about something?

— No! I mean... maybe.

— Maybe?

— The meeting was an opportunity to talk about sex! — Cait can't resist and blurts it out. The blonde is completely shocked, her eyes widen, she turns and stares at the floor.

Cait covers her face, waiting for Adora's reaction. Then she hears a soft laugh. She looks at Adora through her fingers, sees her straighten her hair, and sighs.

— I wanted to talk to you about it too. But I didn't think it was a good idea, you know? After what happened, I thought it was best to drop the subject.

— I didn't want to rush you...

— But I think it's time we talked about it. And to... doing... this?

— Is everything really all right with you? If it's not, I'll understand, I just want you to be honest with me...

Adora turns to Cait, coming closer to her than before, joining their lips in an intense kiss, laying her gently on the sofa. Adora positioned herself between Cait's legs, kissing her passionately until she ran out of air. They broke apart panting, nervous, but their desire spoke louder. Adora kissed her again, moving her hand down to explore her body, until Cait abruptly interrupted.

— Sorry... but can I get ready?

— Huh, yes. Yes, you can! — said the blonde, getting up from her and standing stiffly.

— I won't be long. Five minutes, okay? — she said as she hurried up the stairs, leaving Adora in the living room with flushed cheeks. The blonde looked around, processing the information from just a few seconds ago and how it had thrown her.

Butterflies in her stomach. Was that it? The butterflies resurfaced, bringing with them a mixture of nervousness and passion that she hadn't experienced for a long time. Adora walked to the other side of the room and faced the stairs, turning to face the sofa. She heard Cait coming downstairs and, as she turned around, the other woman surprised her by jumping on top of her, wrapping her waist in her feathers and covering her in kisses. Cait got off the blonde, heading for the bathroom.

Adora stood stunned, unresponsive, her hands hanging in the air, staring at the bathroom door. " *And now...?* " she asked herself, until Cait opened the door and stuck her head out.

— You're lost, aren't you? — She asked, smiling, and Adora shook her head, which made her laugh even more. — Why don't you go upstairs and tidy your room?

— Tidy the room? Okay, I can do that. I can do that. — She replied confidently, but her confidence soon vanished. — Tidy up...?

— Fix it up in a... sexy way? — She said as she went back inside, leaving the blonde alone.

Adora climbed the stairs two steps at a time, quickly reached the bedroom door and entered, looking and analyzing every space, not knowing how to turn it into something sensual.

" *What did she mean by sensual?* " She asked herself, with her hand on her chin. Adora had an idea and hurried downstairs.

— Cait?

— Yeah?

— Can you give me ten minutes? — She heard a laugh and felt uneasy.

— You're asking me for ten minutes, but you know you own the house, don't you? — Cait said between laughs, which drew a sigh of relief from the blonde.

— Okay. Ten minutes.

It's not easy

Cait was already ready, just waiting to enter the room. Even though she could have gone earlier, she was hesitant, her heart beating like crazy. She couldn't wait to see what Adora had prepared. From the bathroom, she only heard footsteps and an amused buzz. As she climbed the stairs, she admired the paintings and thought it was cute that Adora was homely, so different from what people said about her.

When she reached the door and knocked, with no response from Adora, Cait decided to go in. The room was lit by candles, soft music was playing in the background and the curtains were ajar, creating a peculiar atmosphere. The rain continued to fall outside, the cold was felt, but the emotion was so intense that she didn't let the weather get to her. Adora came out of the bathroom and ran into Cait, who gave her a sincere smile.

— That's what I managed to do. Sorry if it doesn't look that amazing, but... well, that's it! — Adora was stunned to realize what she was wearing. " *Is this to tease me?* " she thought, watching her from head to toe as she moved around the room in a seductive manner, purposely rolling over to attract the blonde's attention, leaning against the little table near the window and staring at her. She was wearing a dress with a daring neckline at the bottom, thin straps falling to one side, and her hair loosely combed back. Adora, speechless, sniffled and quickly looked away.

— You really made everything perfect. Thank you, Adora.

— It was nothing. — she replied, trying to avoid looking at Cait, but the woman knew it wouldn't last. Cait slowly approached her, reaching around her and sliding her hand down her body, making her sigh. — I like the dress... It suits you. — she finally commented, turning her gaze to her, coming face to face with Cait, who encircled her neck, making Adora stare directly at her breasts.

Adora took a deep breath, unable to look away. " *They're bigger than I thought.* " she thought, observing the curve of her breasts and how voluminous they were, which made her look even more stunning in that dress.

— You know, I had other options... Do you want to know why I chose this one? — she said, whispering close to her mouth. Adora put her hands on Cait's waist, brushing her lips. — *Because I knew it would drive you crazy!* — Adora joined their lips in a searing kiss, bringing her hands down and squeezing her ass. Cait grabbed her neck, giving it a gentle suck, pulling her hair at the nape of her neck, and kissed the blonde on the lips again. Adora interrupted the kiss, whispering in her ear.

— I thought I could control myself in this situation, but you know what... I' *m tired of being affectionate.*

— That's all right. I didn't expect you to be. — Adora pushed her against the wall and made her wrap her legs around his waist. The blonde held her body tightly, sliding down. Adora walked over to the bed, threw Cait onto it, and pulled up part of her dress, exposing her breasts. She traced a path from her neck to her left breast, nibbling and sucking gently, squeezing the other.

"It's so good to squeeze." thought the blonde, staring at her as she sucked on her breast. Cait kept her eyes closed, panting, gripping the sheet tightly. Adora stopped sucking her breast and moved on to the other, licking and biting lightly, making Cait arch her back.

— *Adora!* — She moaned her name, holding her head. Adora pulled her hand away from her hair, traced her belly and down to her thighs. Adora lifted one leg and left several marks all over that area, until she reached her private parts. She licked gently, just to tease her, and she responded with a murmur. — You like teasing me, don't you? — Cait asked, leaning on her arms to face her.

— I'm making up for it. — Adora replied as she turned her back, removed the rest of her dress and held her waist firmly, making

her thrust her hips out.

Cait buried her head in the bed and squeezed harder when she felt the blonde's tongue run down her body and into her ass. Adora inserted a finger, licking the entrance and adding a second. The blonde kept his fingers inside her, kissing his way up her back and holding her neck.

— Ever since we started dating, I've been holding back. But now I'm going to repay you for all the times you've teased me.

— When did I tease you? — She asked excitedly, tilting her head to the side. Adora continued to kiss her neck, moving in slowly.

— Are you going to say that dress you wore to the Frosta dinner last month wasn't meant to tease me? — she asked, thrusting into Cait, making her moan loudly.

— Okay... maybe I was teasing you. You can't blame me, I really wanted to see your reaction. *Y-You* didn't take your eyes off me for a second- *Ahn-!*

— It was mean to do that. — Adora left a hickey on her neck and resumed the kissing trail, penetrating her more firmly. Cait began to moan louder with each thrust from the blonde, her already damp fingers making the movements easier.

— *Shit* ... — She muttered, raising her head panting. Even though the sky was falling outside, the room was still warm. Their sweaty, uncontrolled bodies made the bed creak, while their moans reverberated around the room. Adora was enjoying it, and a slight smile appeared on her lips as she went back to caressing the other woman's body, running her tongue from her waist to the nape of her neck.

Adora realized that she was about to climax, but wanted to have more fun. Looking around, she spotted a strip on the table next to the door; she took her fingers out of it, leaving her confused. — What are you going to do...? — Cait asked, watching the blonde climb into bed with a mischievous smile.

— I told you I'd make it up to you. — she said amused, blindfolding Cait, who was surprised at first. Once Adora had tied the knot, she slowly inserted her fingers inside Cait before starting to move more intensely. — Or would you prefer me to stop? If it bothers you, I can stop... — the blonde murmured as she brushed her lips across her ear. Cait moaned as she thrust faster and faster, finding the blonde's audacity amusing. It was the first time she'd seen Adora like this, and she was enjoying it.

— If you stop, I swear I won't speak to you for a month. — She moaned again, leaving Adora fascinated, closing her eyes tightly and speeding up her movements, her moans getting out of control. Adora propped herself up on the bed with one arm, and Cait held her tight.

With a few more thrusts, Cait finally climaxed, letting out a moan that filled the room, squeezing the blonde's hand, her face also flushed. Adora released Cait, who fell panting onto the bed. Cait turned around and sealed their lips. The blonde got between her legs and kissed her neck, but then stopped and lay down between her breasts, sighing.

— I think I'm going to go crazy like this...

~11pm~

Restless, Adora got up and went to get a drink, but when she returned to her room, she couldn't drink it. She put the drink to one side, watching the rain that was gradually stopping. She sighed and scratched her head, jumping a little when Cait hugged her from behind.

— Not sleepy? — Cait asked, and the blonde shook her head. — Can I ask you a question? — she said quietly, making Adora's body shiver with the warmth of her breath.

— Go ahead. — she replied, closing her eyes and enjoying the moment.

— Why didn't you take your shirt off?

— I can answer that, as long as you answer me first.

— About?

— About everything! Why didn't you tell me?

— Oh, that... — Her voice came out slurred, she sighed and turned away from the blonde. — I don't know when it started. Sometimes I'm well and then suddenly I'm ill. I don't know how to control it or if there's a cure. I've been to several doctors and all they tell me is to eat properly.

— So why don't you do it? — she asked, making her angry.

— Because it's not easy! It's more complicated, it's not just about food, but nobody understands! — She exclaimed, turning her back on Adora, covering her face with her hands and sighing heavily.

— Cait...

— I think I've always been like this. But it got worse after he died. My parents forced me to eat, because otherwise I would have died. I know I have to eat, but sometimes I just can't! The thought of facing a plate of food puts a huge pressure on my chest, fucking with my head! — Adora listens to every word that comes out of her mouth, watching her clench her fists. — It's not the first time I've heard that: “You have to eat”. Everyone says that, and it's exhausting! I know I have to make an effort, but it's so tiring! — she vents, her watery eyes turning to Adora. — *Damn* ... — she mumbles, wiping away her tears. Adora approaches her, hugging her, and Cait returns the hug, wrapping her arms around the blonde's waist.

Adora walks over to her, takes her face in her hands and kisses her once more, making her back hit the table.

— I didn't tell you... Because this is my fight. And I have to fight it alone. — She says weakly before being pulled into another kiss by the blonde, holding her thighs and making her climb onto the table.

— It's not true... — Adora whispered. — I didn't want to take my shirt off because I didn't want you to see my results. — Cait raised an eyebrow in confusion, and Adora moved away a little to take off her shirt, revealing several marks on her body.

— Results...? — She asked, running her finger along a cut that ran from her chest to her collarbone. Usually wearing clothes that hid her entire body, it was rare to see any visible marks on her for this reason.

— I also thought I should fight alone. And yes, some struggles we should face alone, but that doesn't mean we should hide from the people who care about us. — She sighed, holding her hand and sliding it down her abdomen to feel all the scars she carried. — I also died when she was gone, and even when I learned to live with the loss, the pain persisted. Even back in Etheria, I kept getting involved in fights, all to feel a little pain. I wanted to expel this pain from me, but I didn't have the courage to hurt myself, so I looked for other ways to feel it.

Adora lets go of her hand, but the woman still stares at her marks. Cait interrupted the touch, sighing deeply and massaging her frown with her hands.

— I want you to know that it's okay not to want to show all your marks. Not everyone will understand, and they'll keep repeating the same thing to you. — she says, remembering when her friends used to repeat the same phrase to her. *"Move on"*. — But I understand! You can be honest with me. Maybe I don't understand everything, but I want to learn how to take care of you. So tell me when it's bad. Give me some warning, and I'll come running to hug you and I won't let go. — Cait lets a few tears fall, moved, smiling at Adora.

— Promise?

— I promise! — The blonde kisses the corner of Cait's lips and hugs her.

~2:25 am~

Adora moves on the bed, kissing Cait's half-naked body. — Still awake...? — she asks, sleepily, turning towards her.

— I'm just anxious... I can't sleep, and I don't want to drink. — she replied, kissing her belly as she opened the shirt she was wearing. Cait removed the top sheet, making room for the blonde to snuggle between her legs. Adora parted her lips and moved down to her neck, running the tip of her nose along her collarbone, enjoying her perfume. She smiled when she felt Cait put her hand on the back of her neck. — You like pulling my hair, don't you? If you keep this up, I'm going to go bald. — She joked, kissing her cheek. Cait laughed softly, digging her fingers deeper into her hair.

— Are we going? — She asked anxiously.

— I'll go slowly. If it hurts, let me know, OK? — she said, getting up to take off her pants. Cait settled on the bed, waiting for the blonde to climb back on, and closed her eyes. She heard the bed creak and felt Adora get between her legs, holding her face and sealing her lips.

Cait smiled during the kiss, stroking the blonde's cheek gently. It's funny how Adora can be so serious and sweet at the same time. Adora gently guides herself into Cait, allowing her to get used to the movement. Cait holds her body, hiding her face in the crook of her neck, while she whispers words in her ear, begging for more.

Adora supports herself on the bed with her arms so as not to put all her weight on Cait, intensifying her movements. Moaning and scratching her back, their pleasure intertwined, making it impossible to contain their moans. Cait was panting and sweating, signaling her coming climax. The blonde considered going slow, but she wouldn't let her, assuring her that everything was fine. Cait held her head, surrendering to the pleasure, while Adora continued, cumming afterward.

The blonde stands up to see her face, her mouth open, taking a deep breath. She can't contain her smile, laughing out loud and infecting Cait, who doesn't understand why she's laughing.

— Why are you laughing? Haha! — asked Cait, unable to control her laughter. Adora threw herself down next to her, and Cait turned to face her, still laughing. Adora took a deep breath after all the laughter.

— I guess... Heh... I'm just happy! — she said, stroking her cheek with her finger. Cait took her hand and kissed it, she felt happy too, with butterflies in her stomach.

Cait pulled the sheet over them, snuggling into Adora's embrace, feeling sleep coming on. Adora smiled with her eyes closed, kissing Cait's head, who was already sleeping peacefully. A shiver ran down Adora's spine, and she opened her eyes, staring at the wall.

When she was alone, the blonde usually stared at the wall before going to bed, whether she was sober or drunk. Sleep insisted on coming. She felt trapped in an endless nightmare.

"*Adora. The nightmare is over. Close your eyes, I'm with you.*"

She slowly closed her eyes, surrendering to the sleep she had never imagined she would reach.

Promises

After his late return from the castle, Finn was visibly despondent. Despite the efforts of Melog and the girls to cheer him up, he remained downcast. Ignoring Melog's calls, he headed towards the house, until a noise in the forest caught his attention. Finn looked around, heading in the direction of the mysterious sound. However, before he could proceed, Melog blocked his path, annoying Finn.

— Melog, get out of the way! — He exclaimed, but the feline persisted in meowing, shaking his head and acting agitated.

Determined to lose the feline, Finn set off at a breakneck run, bumping into objects and accidentally tripping over a root, rushing down a ravine. When he got up, complaining of pain, he realized that his leg was bruised and had small cuts. Although he knew his mother wouldn't approve, that was the least of it. Fighting back the tears, he dusted himself off, shook himself and patted his shirt to remove the leaves, realizing what was in front of him.

A tower of the first. Looking around, without recognizing the exact location, he knew he was in the forest of the whisper, although this landscape was unknown to him. He walked with difficulty, reaching the door that opened at his touch. He looked back hesitantly, shook his head and entered.

Inside the tower, he wandered disoriented through the rooms, observing everything with perplexity, but without touching anything. Suddenly, he felt a chill and wrapped his arms around himself, heading for a dark room. He leaned his head in, examining the place, smelling and listening carefully. Everything seemed harmless, so he entered.

With his arms relaxed, he explored his surroundings, noticing that the room resembled a station, reminiscent of the communication towers he had visited with his mother. In the center, there was a

large object of unknown purpose and a table with several shiny buttons.

Without much thought, he shrugged and began pressing the buttons, waiting to see what would happen. After trying many buttons without success, he became irritated and banged his head on the table. Glancing to the side, he noticed a button at the end of the table that caught his eye. Cautiously, he approached the mysterious button, intrigued.

Climbing onto the table, Finn carefully examined the button, which aroused his curiosity because of its different size and location.

After a thorough inspection, he got down from the table and checked his surroundings for clues. Feeling increasingly curious, he decided to press the button carefully, touching it several times before actually pressing it. Even though he held the button down and waited, nothing happened.

With a touch of frustration, he pressed the button again, harder, until an image appeared behind him. In a quick gesture, he turned around, surprised. The recording restarted and kept repeating itself. Noticing the buried button, he moved away from the table towards the door, but a voice called out to him.

He stopped abruptly, turned and faced the person on the recording, becoming even more surprised. Unable to move, his body acted on instinct, walking forward until he was sitting on the floor, his eyes fixed on the image.

He sighed deeply and swallowed. Hearing a noise, she turned quickly and saw Melog standing in the doorway, looking at him seriously. He raised his eyes to her, approaching the little man and settling down beside him.

— I'm sorry I ran away... Are you going to tell her? — He asked, crestfallen, tapping his feet anxiously.

— No. We'll keep it between us, even though we know that sooner or later she'll find out. — said the feline, wagging her tail.

Finn looked up, admiring the woman.

— Who's that? — He asked, tilting his head to the side in curiosity.

— This... is Catra! — He says enthusiastically. — She was a great warrior. Despite her resentments and fears, she fought for good and contributed to saving this world and many others. She was a friend.

— Were you close? — He asked, sitting down cross-legged and watching the excited feline.

— I hadn't known her that long, but from the first time we met, we formed a very strong bond.

— What happened to her? — Finn had never heard of Catra. It was a request that Adora made when they returned to Etheria. At first, they didn't understand, but Adora was very upset, being a completely different Adora to the one they knew, aggressive, anxious, full of fears and carrying a sense of guilt. They didn't want to lose her either, so they respected her wishes.

— It's a long story, but the most important thing is that she's at peace.

— How do you know that?

— Because that was her greatest wish. To live in peace. To bring peace. Although she appeared sullen on the outside, on the inside all she wanted was for everyone to be well. Especially your mother.

— My mother? Do they know each other? — He asked excitedly. The feline laughed at his excitement.

— Of course! Nobody knows Catra better than Adora herself.

— Wow! That's incredible... — Finn smiled shyly, then his smile disappeared as he stood up, looking at Catra seriously.

— Is there a problem? — Melog asked after a few seconds of silence.

— She seems so... Familiar! I feel like I know her somehow. — Finn put his hands on his chest, squeezed and let the tears flow. — *I feel* ... I miss...?

— Finn! — Adora arrived suddenly, startling them both. Melog growled at Adora. — Wait, Melog! It's me!

The feline calmed down and returned to normal size. Finn stared at his mother with wide eyes. Behind her standing Glimmer, Flora, Angel and Cait, all worried about the blond who had left the castle without warning.

— Finn, how many times have I told you! This forest is confusing and huge. You can't go around without someone close by, and Melog, I can't believe you let him out of the castle! What did you... — Adora stopped, raised her head and took a deep breath.

Glimmer looked at her incredulously. Catra. I hadn't seen her face for so long... And she was there the whole time. Adora said there was nothing of her. Adora lied.

The blonde despaired, staring at the table full of buttons moving in her direction, and then her gaze fixed on the record button.

— What have you done? — she shouted at the little boy, who cowered, hugging himself.

— I-I... — he couldn't speak, he was too scared, and his eyes were full.

— Adora! — called Glimmer, visibly annoyed. — How long has this been here? — Adora sighed in frustration, shaking her head and rubbing her face with her hands.

— When I started building the house... I found the tower, I went into it and the memories started resurfacing and I-I... I recorded this memory!

— Why didn't you tell us?

— I don't know! I think I wanted it all to myself... — she said between sobs. Glimmer sighed and shook his head, looking at the cat with watery eyes. Didn't they deserve to know? — I was a fool! — she suddenly exclaimed, making the queen stare at her. — You deserved to know. But I... I was so broken that when it happened I just didn't know what to do! I'm sorry... — Adora burst into tears, and Glimmer went over to her and hugged her.

— I understand it was difficult, I was just... surprised. — She said, pulling away and stroking his cheek with her thumb. Adora looked at Finn, still hugging him, her mind going back to the day she met him.

Just as he was cowering and afraid, Adora felt her stomach clench, mentally punishing herself for shouting at him. She approached slowly, still unsure, and he stepped back, shaking his head to get away.

— I'm sorry, Finn... — Adora tried again, kneeling on one leg. — I haven't been the mother you deserve. I'm trying... but I don't know how. — She kept her gaze down, sighing tiredly.

— It was my fault... — He mumbled through his tears. — It was my fault they left! — She screamed, hurting her arm with her claws. — I was a burden! It was my fault they left! It was my fault! My fault! — He screamed and sobbed uncontrollably. Flora and Angel wanted to help, but Cait and Glimmer intervened.

— That's not true! — The blonde tried to get closer, but he backed away. Understanding the little boy's fear, she returned to her original position. — It's not your fault. You're not a burden, you're the best thing that ever happened in my life! You are my son. — As she spoke, a shaky smile formed on her face. Gradually, Finn calmed down and took a few steps towards her. — You saved me. You were my light when I felt lost. I'm sorry if I haven't been good enough for you... I've been busy, but I promise to change. I'm really sorry, Finn...

Adora finished, her head down. Finn moved closer, caressing her face and making her look up at him. And, just as before, Catra was also present. The little boy moved a few strands of hair away from the blonde's face, tucked them behind her ear, let out a sob and held her face between his hands, hugging her.

Adora grabbed the little one's waist, lifted him into her arms and hugged him tightly, allowing the tears to flow before letting go. Finn smiled, wiped away the tears and caressed Adora's face, touching their foreheads.

— I love you, my son. Much more than you can imagine. — she whispered to him, and Finn wrapped his arms around her neck, hugging her a little tighter. Adora put the little one down and walked towards Glimmer with her head down. The queen stooped down to meet him.

— I'm sorry for leaving unannounced, auntie... I promise I won't do it again.

— Don't worry, dear. What matters is that you're okay. Remember that we'll always love you. — she said, stroking his cheek. — I see your mother's light in you. A real Grayskull! — she said, with a proud smile on her face, looking at him and Adora.

Getting up, Angel and Flora threw themselves on Finn, hugging him and messing up his hair. They stayed cuddled until Melog, who had joined them, meowed for them to get up.

— Mom, can we explore the tower a bit? — Angel asked. Glimmer looked at Adora, who smiled and agreed.

— Yes! — They were excited. But before they left, Finn turned to them in the doorway, his hands on his waist.

— Remember, we mustn't get involved in anything extremely dangerous, and we must always stay with the...?

— With Melog! — they replied excitedly. Melog took the lead, followed by the children.

In the living room, the atmosphere was still full of tension. Adora, with her arms crossed, took a deep breath, released the air through her nostrils and directed her gaze at Catra's image. She lowered her eyes and apologized once again to Glimmer.

— Adora, it's okay. I miss that wild cat too, hehe! — she said cheerfully. — But know that I'm still here if you need to talk. We're sisters! — She held out her hand formally. Adora smiled, pulled Glimmer by the wrist and hugged her.

— Thanks, Sparkling! — she thanked her, remembering Catra's nicknames.

— Ah, that's nice~ We're going to use our old nicknames again, are we? Wonderful... — Adora laughed, while Glimmer rolled his eyes. — Listen, I want to call Bow and Entrapta to take a look around here and take this recording somewhere else, something better than a closed room.

— What do you mean? — The blonde asked, frowning.

— It's time we did something we should have done a long time ago. Build a memorial to our wild cat. — she said, looking at Catra with tenderness.

Adora was speechless and thanked her with a smile that was more than enough for Glimmer. She said goodbye, leaving first, leaving Cait and Adora alone. Cait remained silent the whole time as Adora approached her.

— You never told me she was so beautiful... — she declared softly.

— Yes... — replied Adora, standing next to her, holding her hand and intertwining their fingers. Cait wasn't jealous or intimidated by Catra, in fact, she was happy to finally meet the cat.

— She's amazing. I'm sure she's very proud of you. — she said, referring to Finn.

— Thank you. — she replied, taking a deep breath as she looked at the cat once more. — I want to believe that... she's proud of me. But sometimes I still have my doubts. — Cait squeezed the blonde's hand, resting her head on her arm.

— She's proud! Don't doubt it. And you should be proud, too.

After leaving the room, Adora turned back to close the door, hurriedly switched off the lights, but froze when she heard the cat's voice.

— Hey, Adora~

The camera started rolling unexpectedly, she looked at the button, and it was still buried, there was no way to start filming. His big smile brought lightness to her heart.

Cait appeared in the doorway, calling out to her, but stopped beside her, staring at the cat with delight.

— The recording suddenly started playing... — Adora explained as Cait stared at her in confusion.

— Maybe she wanted to talk to you. — Cait said with a smile, leaving first.

Adora reflected on Cait's words. She cast one last glance at Catra, turned and left the room with a big smile.

Before joining the girls outside, Adora used her magical ability to close the door. Hand in hand, they were led back to the castle by Glimmer. Bow and Entrapta were told about the recording, and then the other princesses were told about building a special memorial to Catra. Joy spread among everyone, while Scorpia shed emotional tears, being comforted by Perfuma. Adora expressed her gratitude to everyone for their support, said goodbye and returned home with Cait and Finn.

As they prepared something to eat, Finn shared his feelings of guilt about the situation with Cait. With simple words, Cait

reassured him that everything was fine now. With a hug, Finn calmed down. When he asked Cait to put him to sleep, she agreed and, after they had finished their meal, Finn taken a bath, put on his pajamas and went to bed to wait for Cait.

The woman came into the room with a glass of milk and Melog, who barely fit between her legs, moving around like a small cat. He jumped onto the bed, looking for a cozy place to settle down. With a book in hand, she opened it next to him and started reading. When she realized that the little one had fallen asleep, she closed the book and put it on the side table, holding the empty glass.

As she tried to get up without disturbing the little one's sleep, a small hand grabbed hers. Finn, his eyes clenched shut, began to speak in whispers, raising his head slightly in search of the young brunette.

— Auntie...? Are you going to stay with my mother forever? — She asked, yawning and rubbing her eyes with her other hand. Cait sighed, smiled slightly, released the boy's hand, tucked him under the sheet and tidied his hair.

— Of course, dear. — she whispered close to his face, reassuring him despite his good hearing.

— Even if you don't stay together... will you still come and visit me? — He asked, opening his eyes slightly.

— Yes. You're my brave boy! — She brushed away locks of hair and kissed his forehead, while Finn yawned, turned over and fell asleep.

Cait left the room, closing the door carefully, finding Adora sitting on the stairs with her head down. She sat down next to her, crossed her arms and rested her head on her shoulder.

— So you mean... we're going to be together forever? — She asked, smiling mischievously at Cait, who rolled her eyes and smiled slightly.

— If you still want me... I'll be here.

— That's good to know. — Adora took her lips in a slow kiss. There was no malice in this gesture, just a longing for a wonderful future.

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“ *Hi, Catra... ”*

“ *Hey, Adora! Why are you sad?"*

“ *I don't understand. Sometimes I feel empty."*

“ *Don't worry, you'll fill those voids. I'm sure of it. ”*

“ *Will you forgive me?"*

“ Of course, you idiot! Adora, I wanted to protect you, and I succeeded. Now you have someone who can do what I couldn't. ”

“ But I miss you... ”

“ I miss you too. But it's all right now. Don't worry, I'm finally at peace. ”

“ Will I see you again? ”

“ I don't know... ”

“ ... Maybe... In another life, we could be together. ”

“ We are! From now on, don't regret what you do, Adora. I can't be with you in this life, but I'm with you in others. Either way, I'll always be with you. ”

“ You promise? ”

“ I promise! ”

The best day ever

[...]

While the adults are away, Finn and his friends have fun playing around the castle.

— Hey, Finn! — Flora calls him, and he hugs her enthusiastically. Angel approaches and hugs him too.

— I've got news! — Angel declares, standing in front of the group.

— Tell me soon, Angel! — the twins ask anxiously in unison.

— I overheard our parents talking, and it looks like they're finally going to let us take a trip to another planet! — The children celebrate, jumping for joy.

— Finally! Hey, how about a ride in the mother tree to celebrate? Angel, you can teleport us, can't you?

— Miranda, I still can't control my powers, but I like the idea. Let's walk and stop by that candy store. It's on me!

Together, they head towards the exit, passing the statues that honor those who have passed on. The blond man moves away from the group, looking between them and the statues. Finn searches for the feline figure that always fills his heart with joy. When he finds it, he beckons his friends to move on, and Angel smiles at him, leading the way for the others.

He walked between the large statues and approached it, bending down to pick up the dry leaves that had fallen and kneeling in front of the figure.

— Hi... Sorry I didn't come sooner. I got busy with school and homework. They're a pain! But my mom says I have to do it if I want to go on adventures with the others. — He sighs and lowers his head. A strong gust of wind blows, blowing away the leaves on

the statue. — I still... don't know what this is... — he says, holding back tears. — I feel like I know you somehow. And I miss you so, so much! How can I miss someone I don't even know? — He sighs, closes his eyes and shakes his head. — Why do you make me feel like this? It's like this every time I see you...

Finn couldn't hold back the tears as he closed his eyes tightly and sighed deeply.

— And yet... I can't help liking you. Is that strange...? I have no idea. But I like it. It calms my heart... — he said, wiping away his tears. He smiled to himself, looking at Catra. — I think I'd better go... the guys are waiting. Bye! — He stood up, shook off the dust and headed for the exit.

— Bye, Finn!

When he heard that, the blond was stunned and quickly looked in her direction, but there was no one there, the statue remained motionless, the wind ruffled her hair, but the words he heard were real. Finn smiled broadly, said goodbye and ran excitedly towards his friends. It was just what he needed to make this the best day ever.

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At the top of the castle, the feline calmly watched the children playing. — Catra! — The blue-eyed brunette caught her eye.

— Hi, Mara! Have you been to see Razz? — she replied with a friendly smile. Mara nodded and walked over to look at the children below. — How's the old lady?

— Better than me, haha! For a lady, she's got a lot of energy. And you? Taking a look at the little ones? — Mara asked with a careful look.

— Yes, I wanted to see if everything was all right. — she replied softly.

— They grow up so fast... — Mara commented, watching the children mess around. — I'm glad to hear they have a bright future! — She smiled at Catra, and the feline understood the meaning behind it, returning the smile.

— Of course. Everything is perfect. — said Catra, proudly looking at Finn. She sighed, reached out and patted Mara on the arm. — Let's go! This cat here needs a break.

— Are you sure? If you want, we can stay a little longer... — She raised her eyebrows suggestively.

— Nah~ They're fine. We'll come back another day.

Mara smiled and nodded, walking side by side. Before she left, Catra turned around, blew a kiss in the air and smiled with satisfaction.

— Goodbye, Adora.

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